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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Monday, June 5, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9mHUpagLKuU
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:10:51] The College Partnership Laboratory Schools Standing Committee. I'd like to welcome everyone to the June meeting of the Standing Committee. And with that, I now call us to order. I will note that Andy Rotherham and Bill Hansom have notified us of their use of remote participation because of their principal residence being more than 60 miles from the meeting location today.

[00:11:12] And that has been identified in the public notice. I have approved their remote participation in accordance with the board bylaws and ask that the staff note the remote participation under section 2.2 3708 period 3B3 of the Code of Virginia. So with that, we are going to ask you to please, if you're able to, please join, rise with me. We are going to have a moment of silence followed by a special guest for the Pledge of

[00:11:41] Allegiance. All right, friends, this morning we are joined by a very special guest, Ms. Chapman

[00:12:15] and Mr. Chapman. Ms. Chapman is a rising fifth grader. Good morning. And she is going to lead us in the Pledge of Allegiance. Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for witness and one nation under God, invisible, with liberty and justice for all. All right. Members of the Standing Committee, you were provided a copy of the agenda

[00:12:53] in advance is there a motion to approve the agenda as presented is there a second second all those in favor please by signify by saying aye aye aye the motion carries the agenda is adopted now we'll move to the approval of the minutes members of the standing committee were also provided a copy of the minutes from the april 2023 meeting is there a motion to approve the minutes as presented i second so moved excellent i love it when we're racing in to get the approval in the second all those in favor of the motion please signify by saying aye aye any opposed the

[00:13:29] same the motion carries and the minutes are approved with that we'll now move to the public comment portion of our agenda the standing committee accepts public comment on all matters related to the college partnership laboratory schools in virginia public comment is an important consideration and a valued input to the standing committee the standing committee will accept public comment on agenda items at this section of the agenda public comment on non-agenda items will be accepted upon the conclusion of the business portion of meeting and should there be multiple commenters um we'll be happy to take those comments in the order in which that they

[00:14:03] were received at this point uh mr chapman i believe we have no one who is here for public comment i believe that's correct we did have one person sign up for public comment on a non-agenda okay thank you mr chapman for that clarity oh hearing i have a public comment yes but i think we're looking forward to hearing from you again the standing committee very much values public comment and we look forward to the public's input it's an important consideration of our

[00:14:40] process so thank you for being here all right today is a very exciting day for the standing committee after more than six months of behind the scene work to create a transparent and public process to consider lab school applications we will consider our very first application it has been months of research preparation and diligence to create this transparent and deliberative public process that prioritizes quality durable lab schools staff have been working tirelessly with committee members to prepare tools that for the committee's usage as well as the public's usage and to thoroughly review and evaluate lab school

[00:15:20] applications not merely for completeness and compliance with federal and state laws but for quality and durability and it's through this transparent process and at times a deliberative process that we have gone through but that deliberation is essential to ensure high quality schools for virginian to honor taxpayers to protect children and to ensure that we are good stewards of the task before us as charged by the state board of education so i want to thank everyone for their steadfast commitment to integrity quality collaboration and having a public process

[00:15:54] on behalf of the committee in particular i would like to thank dr jeremy raley for his leadership on this matter mr kent dickey miss dr samantha hollands miss melissa velasquez dr brendan album mr jim chapman miss megan clemens mr edward lanaz miss amy spica and miss susan williams Rebecca Eskew, Dr. John Herndon, and Ms. Lorraine Vineski. As you can see, education is without question a team sport here in Virginia, and it takes a whole lot of subject matter experts to get us to this moment.

[00:16:33] So today we're going to take up the first review of a college lab partnership application. Should the committee, the committee will engage in a deliberation with the applicant. We will hear first from the applicant. We will second then hear the staff report from the subject matter experts. We'll then open it up for questions from committee members.

[00:17:00] Dr. Moran will lead us off on those questions. As we have indicated to the applicant, they will provide an overview of their application, and then the committee members will consume as much time as they may require to engage in a conversation with our applicant. At this time, um so we will formally take up item a which is first review of a college partnership laboratory school application from south side virginia community college um before us today before

[00:17:33] presenting for south side we have dr paul nichols and dr chad patent we welcome you gentlemen and please come up to the podium we'd love to hear more about your application and i believe that you'll be introducing also a number of individuals that are joining you today we will thank you very much we appreciate madam chairman and members of the committee as well as members from the department of education we're very much appreciative of this opportunity i am paul nichols superintendent mecklenburg county public schools i'm in my eighth year as superintendent

[00:18:08] and mecklenburg county if you look on the map behind you of the state divided into the various superintendent's regions. Mecklenburg is in region eight. We're in the middle at the bottom on the North Carolina border. The whole region is a region that is traditionally agricultural with tobacco being the king. It's been slow to move into the modern age. I remember as a school counselor in Brunswick County in 1985 when NAFTA and the whole change in the agricultural field

[00:18:46] and the military pretty much put us in a position where roughly 80 percent of our students really had to look for careers and what careers were going to mean for their future because they were used to just going back on the farm or going into the old types of manufacturing or going into the military and it's been a passion of mine ever since then to be looking at careers and working with careers mecklenburg county and all of the counties in region eight have worked very closely with the community college which is south side virginia community college i believe it has the

[00:19:24] largest territorial footprint of a community college in the commonwealth of virginia and we've worked with them for many years with dual enrollment so working together is nothing new i I think the point of our lab school application is that, and coming into Mecklenburg County, we have focused a lot on trying to coordinate our efforts to really move beyond the minimum competencies of the standards of learning to preparing students as the state has been

[00:19:59] advocating for careers and college preparation, if in fact college was necessary to prepare them for careers beyond college. For so long, and I can say this as a former school counselor, we have focused on just preparing students for college. But there's so many careers out there that are beyond that. And we were a divided county. We've been successful in completing now the culmination and bringing together of the east end of the county and the west end of the county

[00:20:32] with a new middle and high school that was built on the foundation of college, excuse me, of career introduction in elementary schools, career exploration with significant hands-on work through GoTech program in our middle school, and then the establishment of six career academies in our high school. And we've provided for the committee and the Department of Ed a significant amount of information about that process our lab school experience is specifically geared at working

[00:21:06] with the students who are at greatest risk the students who because of covid and higher anxieties or social media issues with those types of things or generational poverty which we have in mecklenburg county 100 of our students getting free and reduced price lunch close to 70 percent that qualify for free or reduced price by the specific guidelines we are a growing community but there's still a

significant number of our students coming from those backgrounds and so our goal has truly been to identify work with those students with this

[00:21:46] to get them prepared for the dual enrollment again we've worked very closely with the community college throughout the years that's primarily been on an academic basis but now we are expanding our ctes we've expanded with our six career academies lots of opportunities for the industrial certifications lots of opportunities for bringing people from business and industry in i'm going to let dr patten introduce our guests but we have representatives from both of those groups with us today and put the students in a position so that beginning at eighth and ninth

[00:22:25] grade we can make sure that those students who are at risk can be prepared for the dual enrollment classes and the seamless system moving from high school into community college to to complete what they can and then take various levels above and beyond with the community college before going into the working world so i'm going to let dr patten pick it up from there but we'll be glad to answer many questions beyond that and good morning and um i'm chair just like say thank you Thank you for the opportunity to be here and members from the committee.

[00:22:58] I've got a small army of like-minded educators that are behind this project. I would like to introduce the ones that are that are here today. And so we have Miss Shamia Moody from Mecklenburg County Public School.

[00:23:13] She is a special projects coordinator. Then Miss Wendy Ezell. She's our coordinator for dual enrollment for Southside Virginia Community College. Kelly Edwards, our grant specialist for the college, and then Ms. Andy Collette is the Director of Economic Development for Mecklenburg County, and Ms. Kelly Arnold works with Microsoft.

[00:23:41] Welcome, and thank you very much for not only your collaboration and participation in this process, but for taking the time to be here this morning. That just further speaks to your commitment to the overall partnership, so thank you for doing that and being part of this discussion. So many people have been involved, and I'd like to thank all of them, but I would also like to thank members that are seated over here that have just been helpful in the project, and that includes you and Dr. Barisi and others, and it truly is a partnership, and so we're very thankful for that.

[00:24:11] I thought about how to best describe this, this school and the impact that it that it could have. And I think Mr. Nichols did a great job. Wendy Ezel said from the beginning of this project that what we think is needed is something along the lines of a middle school, excuse me, excuse me, governor school project for students who are currently just falling below the mark, who normally wouldn't qualify for dual school.

[00:24:42] enrollment courses in their 11th and 12th grades and so that's what we set about to do so and very briefly we're looking at students in the eighth and ninth grade level who have risk factors who are falling between 1.5 and 1.9 gpa and we want to use a cohort model to uplift them engage them show them what's possible and what's waiting for them in our region We can just get them to earn some credentials and some certifications.

[00:25:18] And so that's the premise of it. Before I turn it over to our guests to talk about the need and the things that are going over in the county, I'd just like to talk a little bit about the academic tracks. And it's agricultural science, computer science, health science, and industrial science.

[00:25:38] And there's great jobs and great careers in our region right now that do not require a four-year or graduate school degree. And those are available. So the reason I'm so excited about this project, it's taking a group of students who normally would just miss out on those opportunities and encouraging them, use a cohort model, bring them along so that they can step out of high school and step out of lab school and earn a life-sustaining wage. It'll make a difference in their lives. So we're very excited about that. To speak about Mecklenburg County and the different

[00:26:13] things going on there, the economic opportunities. I'll turn it over to Ms. Angie Collette. Good morning and welcome again. Good morning. Thank you. As Chad said, I am actually not an educator, so I feel kind of foreign in this arena, but I can speak to the workforce side of things, being in economic development. I've also had two kids go through our school system.

[00:26:42] We've got so many great things going on now in the county. Microsoft has been there since 2010 and expanded now eight to nine times. They've taken all of our industrial parks except one. So I'm looking for some new land. So it has brought a lot of changes and technology to our community.

[00:27:01] In rural communities, we are used to partnering and working together because we don't have the resources that the urban areas do have. So partnerships like this are second nature to us. The community college, the school system, the county, we have all worked together seamlessly for years to accomplish things like this.

[00:27:22] I am excited about it selfishly because I've got companies that are looking for a workforce, and this is going to give them another tool in their toolbox. these kids that already know they're not going to college can get these certificates and go right into our workforce and earn sometimes more than the ones that have gone to college and have this pretty piece of paper. So I'm excited about that. Our office and our county is supportive of this application, and we look forward to you guys giving us a yes. Thank you. Before I introduce

[00:27:59] Kelly Arnold, I would like to make mention that another reason that this is so exciting is the people who have come together to work on this and plan have been parents with students in the public school system. So it's been exciting to work with them and build off that energy to make something great. This time I'll ask Kelly Arnold to come up from Microsoft. Good morning. Welcome. Good morning.

[00:28:25] Thank you for having me today. Very excited to be here to collaborate with this amazing group of individuals. Microsoft is excited, of course, to be in Mecklenburg County. We're excited for the opportunity as angie stated since 2010 we've been there our footprint keeps growing and expanding when you talk about the digital transformation that's happening now with ai and with chat gpt and of course with the data center storage needs we need a workforce and so we realize that the jobs the entry-level jobs are really focused on three pillars and they're hitting all three pillars with the things that they'll be accomplishing through the lab schools we started with the

[00:29:05] the Microsoft Data Center Academy program, which was an ability to upskill individuals and also train individuals in technology for data center career paths. And from there, that program has grown to incorporate critical environments, which we are looking forward to hopefully in the fall, have one of the robust programs stood up there, but also cabling, which you understand the importance of telecom cabling that goes with digital skills. So again, the partnership has been great it's been a wonderful opportunity to partner with becklenburg public schools and also with the community college and of course the state with all that you do to support that just to

[00:29:45] continue to grow a workforce but that are jobs that have really good paying life-sustaining wages and that take people that are in a lot of poverty situations or low-income situations and are able to transform lives. So for that, we are very excited and like, we'd like to continue growing the footprint. So thank you. Thank you. Microsoft has been a wonderful partner. But when you think of Microsoft, you immediately go to computer science or to the data center preparation, and they've contributed mightily. At the same time, what so many people don't understand about

[00:30:22] Microsoft coming into Mecklenburg County is they are so aware of the environment and the environmental impact that is being made. They've contributed greatly to our changes in teaching agricultural production and agricultural programs. They've contributed for our elementary education introduction. They've contributed the hydroponic programs that our students are learning about hydroponics. They've contributed our greenhouses for the academies for the middle and the high

[00:30:57] school. They've contributed in so many ways the components that are related to even our auto mechanics program because they have to have diesel backup generators and electrical systems and all the types of things to go into that. So there are jobs available in those areas as well outside of just the data center and the computer science. It's been a wonderful partnership. They're not the only ones, but they do so much. Thank you. Thank you. Yeah, and just want to thank you for this opportunity, and we look forward to answering questions if appropriate. Super. Thank you, Dr.

[00:31:36] Pat. Well, Dr. Nichols. I'm at the ground zero with these, and I do want to mention one of the things that from the school's perspective is exciting and will be impactful for the rest of our system is that we run into barriers today with a teacher shortage we run into barriers with being able to attract business persons from the various career areas to come in and teach our students

[00:32:15] we run into situations where the the focus that we've had on the standards of learning for so long have taught students to memorize take a test and go on without so much of the hands-on applications and so within our application you'll see components that address those uh such as teacher licensure if we're focusing as much as we are on dual enrollment it's it's there are differences in what's expected of a community college instructor and what's expected for licensure of a high school

[00:32:51] teacher but we're bringing the two together we're very anxious to be able to have the opportunity to have the person that's the community college approved instructor be able to work with our students and and not necessarily expect of them all of the licensure issues that are creating barriers for our students we also have recognized that in order to graduate with a regular high school diploma in virginia there's been a lot of focus on passing classes that are the traditional math classes traditional algebra traditional geometry science classes like traditional

[00:33:31] physics or chemistry or things of that nature it's very hard to find those teachers and and of more importance is you can finish your math requirements including algebra and geometry at the end of the 10th grade having had math ever since second grade focusing on all types of components but because they've memorized them with a two-year gap going to the community college they can have to have remediation going into the business world they don't you hear all the time these kids can't read

[00:34:09] a ruler they've had fractions since the second grade we'd like to look at ways to be able to blend the math, science, and the CTE programs so that they're continuously engaging with those programs, with the math, with the science, through the 12th grade, getting feedback from the business and industries when they go out and do workforce development. They say, well, they can't read a ruler. Well, let's

reinforce that. Let's show them the practical applications of that. So there's some components there that help us with those components, barriers of finding teachers, working with them and keeping them in place.

[00:34:46] And I think that's going to have a huge impact on the rest of our school as well. So I needed to throw that in. I'm glad you did, Dr. Nichols. Thank you. Thank you. And I appreciate the efficiency by which you presented an overview on your application this morning. For the public's benefit, looking at the file online, it is an exhaustive application with numerous addendums.

[00:35:06] You have presented a very thorough application. And at this time, we're going to hear from Dr. Raley, who is going to describe the completeness and compliance review process that the BDOE underwent for your application.

[00:35:22] Dr. Raley, welcome. Thank you, Ms. Wadisca. Good morning. And I'll tell you, it's a pleasure and an honor to be a part of the process. When I started the job on April the 17th, that Friday, I met with Dr. Coons, and she asked me to lead this work forward. And I'm really thankful to have the opportunity to be a part of what I think is an amazing opportunity for students across the Commonwealth.

[00:35:44] So thankful to be just a little part of the work moving forward. I do want to thank the standing member, the subject matter experts who have been a part of the work alongside my team over the course of the past several weeks. And you referenced them in your introduction.

[00:35:59] And I'll tell you, they've done a great job of providing a perspective on these applications that is worthy. I just want to again publicly thank them for their role and participation in this. We received the application from Southern Virginia Community College on April the 10th. Upon receipt our staff conducted a review during the week of April the 17th and as you mentioned several subject matter experts were a part of that perspective anywhere from finance to assessment to instruction from a governance standpoint so we have representative individuals who looked at the application through

[00:36:34] multiple lenses. Our initial review, we had some feedback for the applicants, shared that feedback with them. And what I want to elevate regarding this application is both Mr. Nichols and Dr. Patton were very receptive to that feedback. Oftentimes when you pour your heart and soul into work, when you get feedback, it may sting a little bit, but ultimately they absorbed that feedback and they were very open to coaching. And so they worked with a coach over the course of the past several weeks to internalize that feedback and then come back with a more robust

[00:37:11] application and answer many of the questions that the subject matter experts had in the initial review. So I do want to thank them for their willingness to receive that feedback and then come back through the process. So it demonstrates how this is an iterative process as we are working through these important applications. As our team reviewed the applications, we looked at it again through multiple lenses based on subject matter expertise and as we were trying to determine whether or not the application was complete or compliant we looked at the definition of a lab school and what truly is a lab school and looked at it through two different lenses and recognizing

[00:37:46] that a college partnership lab school can be one of two things number one a standalone entity which is a standalone school as we would come to know it in our own world where that school would be responsible for obtaining its own accreditation and it would be working independently of any sort of school division support and then the other way to get to being within the realm of a lab school and be

defined as a lab school is more like we see in our governor schools models where the school can collaborate with the local school division and an institute of higher education and can utilize the local school division's accreditation and accountability structure in

[00:38:25] order to meet the compliance of the law so as we are looking not only at south side's application but the other application which you'll consider today that was some of the things that we considered for presenting it to you today you have in your packet feedback from the subject matter experts you can see a thorough review based on a variety of factors and extensive analysis of completeness and compliance with constructive feedback throughout the process so you can see that review but ultimately i'm here to represent staff and if you have any questions regarding that review i'm happy to answer them at this time but uh presenting this to you today for your

[00:39:00] consideration thank you dr reilly at this time we will begin the process to entertain questions from committee members again for the benefit of the public online on the doe virginia.gov website you'll see the full and complete application is submitted from south side all the addendums therein the letters of support some of which have been alluded to today as well as a very thorough report drafted by the Virginia Department of Education subject matter experts regarding the completeness and compliance of this application with some additional remarks where you can

[00:39:38] see through the deliberative process that they've gone through, just as described, that an item was considered, maybe some additional refinement was necessary, that refinement has been made and has been further noted, all transparently documented and represented.

[00:39:53] So at this time, what I'd like to do is go to Dr. Moran, followed by Mr. Bailey, followed by Mr. Rotherham, and then by Mr. Hanson. Thank you. And I was delighted to read this proposal. It really spoke to me because I feel that there is nothing more important than being sure that when our kids graduate high school, that they're able to have pathways and lots of opportunities that will give them the chance to thrive in life.

[00:40:24] And for me, that's not just about work, but it's about what they're able to do in their own homes as well as in their own communities. And the idea that what you're building is the capability for young people to see opportunities right there in the Mecklenburg and even surrounding counties that will allow kids to stay close to home if that's what they so choose to do and not feel that they are compelled to leave to find a good job somewhere else.

[00:40:52] And every community needs its young people, and they are part of what makes every community thrive. We can't have communities that grow old and the young people keep leaving to go elsewhere. So I see this as really addressing something that's near and dear to my heart.

[00:41:10] I loved, there were a number of different pieces in there that as an educator and former superintendent that I loved. I love seeing AVID in the mix because I saw great success with AVID in my own school division for years and saw it grow kids into young people who could go, whether it was to community college or to a four-year, and take with them the skill sets that they needed beyond just academics.

[00:41:38] So there are a lot of different pieces in there that I really appreciated. The idea that you see kids that do not necessarily come into middle school or leave middle school with skill sets that they need to be successful in a community college environment.

[00:41:57] And I think every superintendent in the state knows the data that comes out of community college about how many of our kids that walk onto your campuses are ready for the courses or not. And so you can't wait until kids or juniors in high school to start that.

[00:42:13] And if there's anything that I would say, it's that we should be backing that whole process back even beyond middle school into upper elementary. But I so appreciate the time and energy that you put into delineating what will happen in middle school as a precursor to having kids be able to get on that pathway to the community college programs.

[00:42:34] One thing that I also have learned in life is that it's a good thing to start with the end in mind. I learned that from Jay McTighe years ago. And so one of the places I want to go is actually to an operational space as a starting point, because I know that for programs to become sustainable, that they have to have infrastructure and systems built in, that Paul, if you or Dr. Cotton, if you were to leave your positions, that you want to be able to leave intact what's needed to keep that program moving forward.

[00:43:09] And so the question of sustainability for me is not just about financial potential to keep this program alive and moving forward. And I noticed that you do have probably close to $300,000 in personnel costs that are going to be initially funded by the grant proposal.

[00:43:29] It looks like that some of the other kinds of costs You have a pretty clear path to picking those up as a part of your current funding streams and being able to have some time to incorporate that. But I'm wondering how you really see sustainability, both from the standpoint of systems and structures that will transcend the people sitting right here and allow kids five years from now, 10 years from now, to have a program that continues to grow and develop and thrive.

[00:43:57] And then how, on the financial side, you see sustainability as being something that you cannot, that you can build a pathway right now, anticipating that when that personnel cost comes due, that you've got a plan.

[00:44:13] So that's really where I wanted to go. And I hope that wasn't too much information. It's perfectly understandable. I think it's been one of the primary questions that's always been a part of any of the lab school application processes. And of course, as was mentioned earlier, ours is the type where we're building into what we have currently established with the schools. So things that may be huge questions about transportation, about food, things that we're doing that.

[00:44:44] you're asking the question about what I call the booster rocket before you get into outer space and you've got the continuous orbit that's going on. These are the students that need the booster rocket. And we have also established and had established for quite a while the Mecklenburg Business and Education Partnership, McBeat. It's a non-profit organization. It's engaged with business and community. They've already been supporting a number of our students, number of ways with scholarships and things of that nature as we have moved into this process

[00:45:23] they have been the recipient for tax purposes and other purposes of businesses that are are feeding into the school system for the benefit of building the talent pool you mentioned um academically moving down further and further in the middle and elementary school i'm have been of the opinion that the smartest businesses are going to be looking to recruit their employees in middle school and in elementary school by by reaching in and being impactful in their lives and we're seeing that

[00:46:03] happen the local in in various areas microsoft has been contributing and been a part of it the local farm bureau has made a huge commitment through mcbee into providing programs and and opening the doors for businesses to come in and i see what we're asking for is some additional counseling centers uh we're looking for the coordination and and in the packages you see letters from our court system from mental health from the sros from social services from even

[00:46:40] judges that have said these are the wraparound services that we've talked about but have not been coordinated to come together and in contributing in those ways together we will continue to sustain continuing to look for grants as we were coming up here wendy and i had a conversation about a u.s department of education grant that's looking somewhat to do the same thing more specifically with elementary and middle school so i'm sure we will continue to build on success with something like this this being the booster rocket that gets us started then when we

[00:47:16] get into orbit it will it will have a way of continuing students and parents will continue to talk to their children and other friends children and say you need to be a part of this program apply to be a part of this because you want the additional benefit of the avid and the career counselors and things like that that we would be able to put in place as time goes by that's a great concern great question and and as far as south south virginia community college goes nearly 50% of our enrollment is dual enrollment so we have a strong foundation to handle dual enrollment

[00:47:54] programs but as far as sustainability goes this would be new enrollment this is a population that wasn't captured before and of course the more enrollment we have the larger our budget is and we're the community college it's funded on a three-year rolling average and so each of these students has the potential to take 9-12 credits per semester. If you think about that and then think about for every percentage point that our college gains in enrollment, that's an extra

[00:48:28] roughly hundred thousand dollars in our budget. So when we put pencil to that and figured it out, I thought this is very sustainable and that's again one of the exciting parts. This is new enrollment. Thank you. Why don't we just roll around? Let's go through your whole list.

[00:48:52] okay we'll go through your whole list i'm sorry that's okay we'll go through dr marant's whole list and then we'll go to the other numbers and that way and then we'll all circle back one more time at the end just in case something has the the other piece that was on my mind if you started with the end in mind which is how do we make this program sustainable i want to back up to the the criteria piece at the beginning the entry into the program and wondering if you might um add a little

[00:49:23] bit of clarity to um the criteria for kids entering i understood the the gpa piece as being the 2.0 is kind of like a cut score i'd like to think if somebody was a 2.07 they might not get uh taken out of the pool because they're right on that edge but i see that you also talk about you know some of the risk factors and i'm wondering if you could could both address in terms of i know that we have to always deal with privacy issues around criteria related to risk

[00:49:58] but also i'm wondering if you might talk about how you will determine whether someone is there going to be a rubric or some way of being able to say this child hits this factor this factor this factor so therefore they go into the pool if you have a little more specificity all our doctor Yeah, Dr. Patton, we might get comfortable and have a state with us.

[00:50:23] And Dr. Raley, I suspect we may have a couple of questions for staff, too. And if any of these questions that are being asked by a member of the committee, a staff would like to share the staff's view on that item. But we're going to be here for a little while, so I'd like you to get comfortable. Thank you.

[00:50:40] Are these mice working? Okay. Yes. Yes. so um as we work with our consultant that you all provided very nicely um that was a big question because there's a component of the last school that does require that people apply and that we have the opportunity to do somewhat of uh um where it's not going to come to me now but they have a screening screened a lot of the lottery and um from our perspective there are a lot of

[00:51:20] children a lot of students now and i would say particularly post-covid that are are exhibiting some anxieties that are really dealing with social emotional pressures that had not been there before as i mentioned earlier we have we are an area with a lot of generational poverty we are an area that is a high minority population and growing because latino students have been

[00:51:57] coming into our area latino families are coming into our area for several of the jobs that are in the sector and so the the need is greatly there again i think we're going to be in a position that as we get open the doors there will be some recommendations of have you considered this as a a way of getting extra support. But I expect that to pretty much take off when we have those opportunities being recognized and the differences that are coming out of people that are coming in

[00:52:35] and saying, no, I want my child to get the extra help that some of these provisions with extra counseling, things of that nature, knowing they're having direct access. All of our students through the academies have got access to business and industries that are supporting them. But to have the extra hands up, the closer attention of maybe the smaller cohort size as opposed to the 280 students or 300 students per class, I think that'll be beneficial for them as they go along.

[00:53:09] So yes, and also to answer your question, a rubric model was what we were thinking about, because there's a long list of risk factors, and we want to be sure to take in consideration of those. Now, the high school and the community college already deal with privacy. And so we would rely on them as well to help us put that together to make sure that we're following all the state requirements and policies. And the other piece of that is I do think it will be successful and you will have more and more people that would like to come in to the program. But we already

[00:53:46] have avenues and programs for, let's say someone has a 4.0, you know, we can, they will go in the governor's school and they can take the science track for engineering and those sorts of things. So we're laser focused on that group that has the risk factors. And I think that the other piece that I had on, I have a little list here, as, and this is a question and it also speaks to Jeremy, to dr reilly being at the table with you and that is that one of the things that we know is that

[00:54:24] whether it's at the level of law or the level of state policy that sometimes soa considerations can become such a challenge that's something that you really feel would be of benefit to be able to do and you'd like to be a little more out of the box you realize we're constrained we've got to stay in this box and we're trying to make sure that as each of the grants comes forward we want to hear are there places where you would say this is a challenge and this is one that that we would like to maybe be able to work a little bit differently but we are constrained because we're trying to

[00:55:02] stay in that compliance um in the banks of the river inside the banks of the river of compliance but if we had a chance to see something change this is something that would have helped us even to get this grant and if there was a chance to see it changed in the future we'd like to to at least have it put on our tickler list anything that jumped out at you well i mentioned a couple of them some of the barriers that were mentioned um and we are very anxious to be able to see particularly again with teacher shortage some opportunities for being

[00:55:40] opening some doors to bring some persons in without having to have six or seven extra classes before they can get fully certified uh to be a identified instructor for the community college i can give you several auto mechanics this year um the um i keep calling it catering but culinary arts program our agriculture program our uh in the nursing program we have lost five candidates

[00:56:13] that i can think of in the last two years for our nursing program because they had to be our ends with a year's experience in a nursing home to be qualified for high school teaching as opposed to an instructor for the community college that needs to be the rn but didn't need that specific type of program now that's that's tough for the medical field to be able to work with them and i understand because nursing assistants well many of the jobs that are available are in nursing homes and they want them to have some of that experience but they will be

[00:56:52] put in workforce development experiences in those categories along the way so i think they could learn together um that's that's a barrier piece the the focus on the sols as well as the soas and the soqs are are um pushing so many of our students to learning to do math by calculator instead of thinking through so many of the processes and and for the purpose of online testing that's necessary but again you understand fractions but do you understand the practical

[00:57:30] realities of of reading the rulers and the hands-on applications of climbing you know on into a home building environment and and squares and things of that nature or the physics or chemistry related to doing hairdressing you know that's very practical applications that are there so it's it's giving giving them those opportunities to get into those businesses and seeing and getting feedback from the persons that are there.

[00:57:59] And another one, and I keep stressing this, that the wraparound services with the support system from so many others makes a difference. There are some barriers to some of our children being able to get into the work world right now that if we can give them more opportunities and experiences for apprenticeships or internships or things of that nature, that could be very, very beneficial.

[00:58:28] And some of those we won't know until we get into it and have the experience to say, oh, no, we run into this problem, how many hours they need to be in certain places or whatever it might be, or in the summer. Another one is with our culinary arts program. We have been able, with significant support from microsoft by a food truck food trucks go out into the community when there's special programs that are going on but they use their culinary arts experiences but it's

[00:59:03] in the evenings and it's on saturdays so it's difficult for some of our students to break away from activities unless you're going to pay them well you can pay them but right now to pay them has to go through the student organizations and they can't be paid through the student organizations So we've got to find creative ways to look at some of those types of things as we're working with them.

[00:59:25] So those are some of the, I think, barriers that you've got. Anything from the community college, Mike? Well, I certainly agree with all that. I'd just like to say, you know, to your point, when there are matters like that, we're making sure we have the right people at the table because there are different requirements for the community college as for the public schools.

[00:59:46] And so one of the great things about this project is it truly is a partnership. And so while we're not an expert in K-12, we make sure that we have the right representatives so that we can navigate. All right. Mr. Bailey.

[01:00:03] All right. Thank you so much. Thanks for just reading through your application. It was so thorough. I know it took a lot of time by all of you and as well as many of your staff. So thank you for all the thoughtfulness in that. I just had a couple of clarifying questions. Oh, and also thank you too for starting from just an economic development, just what you need in your community, where your current job needs are, but also what is forecasted and projected.

[01:00:30] Just anchoring in that felt really came out loud and clear as well as the partnership with Microsoft and local employers. So I just love the fact you started with kind of that ends in mind and then worked backwards from there and with the great partnership with you all. I wanted to talk a little bit more about, you talked a lot about the selection process for students, but I know there's also a little bit of a selection process from the students' perspective themselves in terms of which academy they pursue.

[01:00:58] And so, can you just talk through a little bit about how you help them make the best decision for themselves in terms of which academy and which area to sort of pursue? Sure. Beginning. So, GoTech does a great job, I think, giving students experience in early middle school, right? And then, and you get a menu of things. So, they can taste test a smorgasbord of different careers.

[01:01:28] And then so we plan to continue upon that work as they're in the critical eighth and ninth and beginning of 10th grades. Part of that cohort model would be showing them what's available in the region. You know, a lot of people, when you say Microsoft, they think, oh, I'm going to set at a desk and type on a keyboard. And that's not necessarily true. There's all kinds of different careers that go into a big corporation.

[01:01:56] So our plan is to bring in alums and people who are currently working in the field and say, this is what a day in my life looks like. And let them actually do things that they can and experiment so that they know what direction to take.

[01:02:14] And then Mecklenburg County has done a great job with their academies. so they have those options and then this lab school will have four science tracks from which they can get credentials and college credits certificates through there so it's a it's a pretty broad spectrum what they could choose if i might add over the past eight years how we came to the academies that's what you're asking so go tech i don't know if you're familiar with go tech

[01:02:47] or not but it's been heavily reliant on support from the go virginia economic development program looking specifically at south side and they identified so many of the different rear options job options that would provide good opportunities for students as they came through to go and and to give them hands-on experience so they have in the middle school labs as examples virtual welders real welding machines put on the helmet you see where the beads go for welding

[01:03:23] welders are making a hundred thousand dollars plus they have the robotics that they have the bots that they're learning so much many of the applications they've got the the automated programming options that would go into advanced manufacturing they've got several of the medical programs with the, I don't use the right term, but I call them medical dummies that can do so many of the different things that with hands-on that are working out there. And they identified it. Now,

[01:04:00] when we were looking at the development of Mecklenburg's academy approach, there are 17 career clusters. And so we were looking at how we give students the options of understanding things about careers as early as elementary school. So we pulled together all of our school counselors and had them certified as National Career Development Specialists.

[01:04:25] And they created a comprehensive K-12 program for career introduction at the middle school, career exploration at middle school with the Go Virginia, Go Tech programs and others that we have available. And then the six career academies were looking at how you blend 17 career clusters so that they make sense.

[01:04:47] As an example, you've got the health and human services. Well, that's obviously the medical careers, but it also is helping us prepare our teachers for tomorrow. It's a human service. It works with our social service agencies and those that are interested in psychology and some of the social services.

[01:05:06] Our law and leadership is grounded upon our JROTC program, but it also includes criminal justice. It includes fire science and there's other things that are available through that. of the more interesting ones is the international business and culture the cultural part we're living in an international society so business is obviously international and culture is also international and if you're going into the fine arts if you're interested in drawing or dance or theater or things of that nature you need to be able to build a portfolio that shows your skills and and build it with with learning how to use the technologies how to build web pages how do

[01:05:44] you market yourself how do you do those types of things at the same time business persons need the edge of being creative and so learning some of the arts builds into that piece and you bring the foreign languages and others into that aspect of it and and we built the school and along with the community college because many of our programs in as a specific example the the data center training or the fiber optic training that was mentioned that we'll be doing the cost of putting a lab

[01:06:20] in for that is humongous so if we're working with collaboration with community college then we can send students there we have not only that but many others hvac and things of that nature that that we can get them the appropriate certifications as juniors and seniors and and build in those options and change them out and in time we'll have different opportunities that we'll need to build on so we we built our lab spaces so that they can be take this out put this in for whatever futures may come into them as we're building the programs out right that's helpful

[01:07:00] um i get a little verbose when i talk about you get passionate i can tell it's uh um throughout the application you talked a lot about uh blended learning as being a fundamental way of helping to deliver some of the instruction can you just go one click deeper and talk a little bit more about what kind of blended learning model how do you see that working um one of the specialists that we've worked with through the years who is also an applicant in other areas with ODU is Dr. Karen Sands from ODU uh she's we've worked with her we we had a grant that was put off by

[01:07:37] cohead working with them and with other school divisions with the idea of blended learning pulling classes together uh actually being able our goal with this would actually to be able to identify within the structure of the cte classes the standards of of um learning that are required for eighth grade math sixth seventh and eighth grade math are really focused so much more on the higher order thinking skills for your fundamentals and then you go into your algebra geometry algebra functions and data analysis and things like that the the skills that are there

[01:08:14] for the sol tests we believe can be built into the preparation of the cte programs so to identify those skills specifically and have math teachers that are trained to work with the cte teachers along the way not necessarily uh 140 to 180 hours you know sit and get but being able to stretch that out and say through the course of the programs that you're completing you're going to be able to do this take the test pass them and take advanced academics and get into business and industry and

[01:08:52] be able to work with them and that's going to take some time it's going to take some expertise it's going to take some support from persons at doe to work with us and pass off on that but again that's one of the reasons that we think it's going to be so important to have the three to four years of working with this program to build that capacity thank you mr rotherham this is great sorry i'm mute um i just have a couple quick comments i think we're we're getting into and i don't want to tax our visitors time too much a couple of things i want first to thank them i mean look

[01:09:29] they're the first on the agenda today at our very first lab school meeting when we were still forming the committee and we i mean we didn't even have like a formal uh organized leadership process on on the committee or anything yet, they were there, and we're extremely grateful for them working through this process with us essentially being a guinea pig, but I think that minimizes just how awesome this application, the promise of what they're trying to do here.

[01:09:55] So I just want to echo Pam's point. I think the attention on sustainability is great. I mean, there is a risk, and we've seen this in the Commonwealth with federal charter school dollars. There's a risk that things are temporal and are aimed at resources in the moment, not how do we built something that's built to last over time, and I'm extremely excited about the focus on that.

[01:10:16] I also, look, this is an important part of the state, and I really appreciated the emphasis on boosting kids who need something extra, and I think it's great that our first one, again today, and our first one as we're moving through this process and taking this on first review, is for a more rural part of the state. I think that's really important. That's a part of the state that needs to be in the middle of the education conversation. I think that's exciting. And when we talk about the promise of these, that's, I think, symbolically important that this is an option for the entire Commonwealth, not for any particular part of the Commonwealth. And then

[01:10:52] finally, as I just said, they focus on boosting kids, making sure we have a customized system for kids so that every kid is getting what they need and that those kinds of options are available for families is enormously important.

[01:11:09] The word equity has come under a lot of stress in Virginia and there's a thousand definitions now for a thousand different people. But if it means anything, I think it means making sure we're reaching kids where they are, giving them options, supporting every kid. And this is just a terrific thing to see.

[01:11:25] So I wanna thank you for your time, for coming a couple of times to different parts of Virginia to meet with us. And it's exciting to see this moving forward. Thank you, Mr. Rotherham. Mr. Hansen, do you have any questions or comments that you would like to share with our applicant?

[01:11:46] While we wait for him to come back to us, I have a couple things that I'll share with you. First, I want to echo the feedback that you've already received from the committee members, and I want to thank you for your patience with us.

[01:12:04] You've been as much a partner in our work as we have been in yours, and we have stood up a process. You have patiently allowed us to build a high-quality process, and we appreciate that. And I know that it has meant at times that you have been the recipient of feedback.

[01:12:20] And just as Dr. Raley has indicated, you know, feedback in this process, we hope, we're setting the tone here, that feedback really is a gift and an opportunity for growth. And feedback is a part of our shared commitment to one another to provide the absolute best for Virginia's children.

[01:12:36] So I applaud the tone and your professionalism and your willingness of heart to be a partner with us in this, as well as the staff. We've heard from Dr. Raley just how collaborative you have been, and I can't underscore how appreciative we are of that.

[01:12:55] It's going to be better for the outcome of everyone involved, most importantly, the students you serve. The second thing I want to compliment you on is I think if we had young people sitting in the room like miss chapman what you've outlined today is just pure common sense and sometimes in education it takes innovation an innovation opportunity to allow us to do things that just make good sense and we want every student when we mean all all means all and too often for students

[01:13:28] with a gpa between one and two sense of what my future is may not feel as inclusive and you're really dialing in for students that for whom they may otherwise feel lost or maybe not part of and you're reaching out to them intentionally so that they have everything that they need and they're excited about learning and they're excited about school and that really is a hallmark of personalized learning i know there's so much to conversation about what what are lab schools at the end of the

[01:14:05] day you know lab schools are going to be innovative public schools that really prioritize personalized learning and i think the gift that you are going to give uh all of us in the commonwealth and i'm going to get to my homework list here in a minute dr really knows it's coming his way and the team is the homework and the gift you're going to give us at some point for for anyone who goes through this process is feedback i hope you'll give us two types of feedback and i want to invite that now for you to think about with your team the first part is we'll invite your feedback on how we can improve our process here if there's anything more we can do i mean it has to be a

[01:14:44] two-way street right the second thing is as you're bumping into those points of friction as dr moran indicated that is an amazing insight not only for this committee but we would be we will commit to you that we will help we work with staff to keep track of those items those points of friction we've talked about it here in the committee and we will surface those before on your behalf before the state board of education mr rotherham mr hansen serve on the state board of education every month that this committee meets we provide a written report to the state board of education um we intend to on an ongoing basis provide that type of input to their process because it's real time

[01:15:24] you're out there executing implementing laws to help people and if there's a point of friction it's getting in the way to do good things for kids gosh i can't think of anything more important to know about so i i you're probably going to bump up some more points of friction having been in school systems as we all happen and when that happens i hope you'll raise your hand and surface that for other adults to come to the aid and to assist i it's really important we have this shared commitment in virginia to one another and as you're experiencing things we'll need to

[01:16:04] know about it will want to know about it so okay so there's kind of overview i'd love the connection to workforce too i mean that was that with that question that is just wonderful and i love that you're leading out with that so let me give a little i have a couple questions um and the first is talk to us a little bit about how you will engage families in this opportunity and i'm going to give you a real life example um i have some some individuals in my community that we have a career center not too far away and sometimes the career center is viewed as oh that's for

[01:16:41] other kids that's that's for those kids going to college that's not for my kid i'm not that might be hard i don't want to set them up for failure i want to see them succeed and sometimes having that one-on-one conversation in home around a kitchen table helping explain what the opportunity is is really one of the most impactful ways to really reach out to families and help bring the whole family along in terms of what the opportunity is. I noticed in your plan it talks a bit about social media and outreach. I'm hoping there's more to it. I'm sure there's more to it. Could you walk

[01:17:16] us through what you're thinking about in terms of how will you engage families to know that this is available for their young people? See you smiling, Dr. Pattinson, please. I think you're right that that is very important and we we all get social media to death and so i agree with you it's not enough to say oh look we we made a post uh now certainly we will do those things but really what seems to be very impactful is those relationships and inviting people to come in to see the lab

[01:17:53] school inviting people to come see the labs and touch things and try things and um and tell the success stories and it's one thing if if i tell you how great an opportunity is it's a whole another thing if i invite back someone who just walked that road a year or two ago they can talk to them i also think it's just critically important to have the parents giving us feedback and input right as we build this out and to really listen to the parents to understand what their concerns are and how best to to reach them so we've been very purposeful to include parents through

[01:18:32] throughout the process i'll give some specific examples um we had we have grasp you've heard of the grasp organization but uh it's a it's a statewide not every school division yet several of the key legislators recognized years ago that so many of the students from underprivileged

[01:19:04] families personally families that have not had any college graduates but have focused on going on higher education and grass actually is the organization that is now putting financial aid counseling because one of the biggest barriers is the whole financial aid process financial aid form and for the last three years we've had a grass representative who works calls parents all students goes directly to them steps them through the financial aid process

[01:19:42] directly that has been enormously helpful to them that's what we have in mind with some of that the counselors that we're talking about engaging here an example of specifically what that has touched from business and industry model is that grass counselor worked with a young person who was

taking one of our welding classes and began to talk with him about the funding that that could provide and they said well maybe i will do an internship that child came back from

[01:20:22] his internship in the fall and she came back again and she said um so what are you going to do he said oh i'm going to be a welder when i was working as a intern i was making five thousand dollars a week as an elder excuse me as an intern and and that began to go around to other students and you know again you were talking about sustainability we're we don't want to limit these children and say you'll never go to college i think one of the things that's going to be important is as they

[01:20:59] get into business and industry and business and industry and recognize the potential that they have in different areas then they say we will pay for you to complete your education to do these extra jobs. We've seen that some of those things happen as well. So it's sort of a success builds upon success along the way and we can begin the process by engaging the students more. Thank you.

[01:21:27] Two other questions, broad brush strokes here. And some of this is just to further understand what a lab school is as part of, you know, helping educate both other potential applicants as well as the public. Could you describe briefly how you will provide instruction to students with disabilities and what the coordination will look like between the school system and the community college to ensure compliance and services for students? Again, one of the the great things

[01:22:04] about this lab school is you're you're pulling resources from two organizations. So, you know, the college has uh resources to help such students and and the way we respond we also have the high school and so coming together and working individually think how we can best meet the needs there knowing that you can draw off the resources of the community college or or the high school i think is uh exciting and it's important an example awesome we're having

[01:22:37] a growing population of students identified with autism so as we began working with opportunities to get students engaged with work experiences parents who have autistic children work with us to establish an organization called feet i'm not going to remember exactly what the acronym is for but they said we want to work with your teachers and finding working with business and industry to

[01:23:14] find co-op experiences for these children it has been extraordinarily successful with local businesses that are giving them repetitious types of opportunities and working and the students are so excited and they're bringing that excitement back with them some of the things that they're expected to do in school so we we think that that will grow not just for those with autism but with other uh needs as well and last question you know the the purpose the original purpose of a lab school out of the university of chicago was really to serve as a laboratory for learning

[01:23:53] and teaching how do we improve teaching how do we how do we how do students learn and um for your application how are you thinking about evaluating success and then i know you've already thought about this i'm curious you know and i've read your application as have the other committee members But talk to us just a little bit about how you're thinking and not only how to evaluate success, but how you might be taking those lessons learned and applying them more broadly to your school division.

[01:24:25] I think there's a number of ways to evaluate success in this program. Of course, you've got the standard GPA, right? We're taking students here and let's see after intervention where they will end up. You know, of course, we look at the numbers of enrollment certifications, all of those things.

[01:24:47] But the part I'm really excited about is the cohort model, the AVID, the, you know, giving students a sense of belonging and purpose and taking them through this journey. The great thing about the AVID model is that could expand for the whole school.

[01:25:04] We could take the cohort model and apply it to other parts of the high school. We mentioned blended learning, and I will have the pleasure of working in the career and technical part of the community college.

[01:25:21] And I'm amazed at how many students will say things like, I hate math, but yet in a welding lab, they're doing complex angles, and they're doing math. They just don't recognize they're doing math. So I'm very excited to see how what we learn then can be infused into the curriculum and benefit not only the lab school students, but the entire high school and the entire community college.

[01:25:46] I'm looking forward to the feedback from the business and industry partners, looking significantly for these students are coming out of school and they don't really have a strong ground of this.

[01:26:02] we're theoretical with our development of the standards of learning where are the practical applications of what does it mean for the student to have to have this knowledge but apply it in the real world and get the feedback from that and even tell us where we need to pick up on some of the the needs that are there uh and and specific to students at times um you know students throughout the 12 years of school have have listened to teachers but they they don't always hear what it

[01:26:42] means to them in life it's a different thing when they go into business and industry and somebody says something to them you know you've got great skills but man if you got an attitude and you need to work on that attitude if you're going to be successful you need to have these opportunities you need to have some humility you need to present yourself in a way that you recognize that you're working for me as opposed to just yourself as an individual. And I can't hire you, or I can hire you. And it's important for students to learn how to fail. We don't give our students an attitude of

[01:27:19] learning how to fail in order to be more successful later on. I think that's going to be a measure of success as we're going on. And I'm going to touch on a touchy topic right now with the community College. I think Southern Virginia sort of was the epicenter of a lot of dual enrollment in its early days. And it's good. From the academic, from the CTE perspective, it's been wonderful.

[01:27:50] But to take a high school teacher and say, now you have a master's degree with specific content area, and so you're going to be teaching college level material is a bit of a stretch because they're still high school teachers and they still have parents that are saying but my child never got a c before or they never got a d or never failed anything before surely they're going to get an a and there's there's political pressures and the things of that nature i worked with the program virginia advanced studies strategies that was introducing advanced placement in math science

[01:28:25] and english and areas and there was a bit of a tension developed between community college with dual enrollment and ap and it extended to higher ed in other places as well we can learn from that tension we can learn how to blend the two and work with them well together and that's one of the areas that we're experimenting with as well with our program to make sure that they're able to get the dual enrollment for the credit but also the the significant mastery of skills for

[01:29:01] an ap level um so i think we'll we'll grow in areas like that as well let me do one more round the horn is there are there any further questions for members of the committee all right i um with unless

there's an objective objection from the committee members there are three areas where i would ask the applicant to further sharpen your pencil with staff for some additional information that i believe we will probably need to consider before this body it would probably be helpful

[01:29:35] For your consideration going forward. The first is to what Dr. Moran inquired about, and that's sustainability and the funding program. You've answered the question well, but if you could augment the written, the material that you've provided in writing with a bit more of that modeling information from community college, I think that would be helpful for us.

[01:29:57] the second is on the area of the eligibility criteria and how will you be ensuring student privacy and how will you be selecting or it's kind of almost a two-part it's how do you engage those families how do you identify that information and should they have a change in circumstance such as a a foster child who is now adopted or a single family that is now married you know how um nimbly through your system, will you be navigating such matters? I think that is something we will need to further understand. And those two together, and then the last is a little bit more on family

[01:30:37] engagement. I hear what you're saying. I've read the application. I'd like to see more in writing in terms of what your plans are. There's no objection from the committee members on those three items. Okay. All right. Then at this point, is there a motion to accept this application for first review and clear the application for a 10-day public comment period is there a second all right all those in favor thank you you'll get the next one mr rotherham i know everyone

[01:31:14] wanted in on this one he's like where is that unmute button okay everyone will get to do one today okay all right exactly all right all right so on the motion before us all those in favor please signify by saying aye aye aye motion is unanimously approved congratulations you move forward in the process therefore on behalf of the committee i direct the staff to post the south side application for a 10-day public comment period in accordance with the standing committee's procedures and then compile any comments received for the review of the standing committee when the

[01:31:49] application returns before us for second review in july and we will have that date for you at conclusion of today's meeting congratulations very much we're very appreciative all right at this time i'm going to take a 10-minute recess and we will reconvene thank you very much

[01:46:37] all right with that we are now going to move to item b on our agenda which is first review of college partnership laboratory school application from virginia commonwealth university, VCU. This item will be presented by Dr.

[01:46:56] Cooney Goranson and Dr. McKnight, and we'll be joined also by Dr. Rayleigh, who will be giving a staff report. Please come forward. We look forward to hearing more about your application. Welcome. Thank you very much for your application and thank you for being here today. Thank you so much. And I apologize for not getting your name wrong.

[01:47:16] No, honestly, don't worry about it. I was right next time. I was Kumi Smith for my whole life, and then I told my husband, I must have really loved you to take Goranson, I said, because people, they could at least do Smith, you know, like it's tough, but thank you. Thank you so much for having us here, and I do want to echo the thoughts of our friends from Southside and how appreciative we are of just the video.

[01:47:38] We support the committee's support, the opportunity to even come forward for this, so I'm really excited to be here. thank you so much. I am Dr. Kimi Gornson, the executive director of Code RVA Regional High School, and I've had the privilege of serving in this role since January 2020. Prior to joining the Code RVA team, I served 21 and a half years in Cheshireville County Public Schools, where I was an English teacher, assistant principal, personnel administrator, principal, and then finally the director of middle school leadership. I'm here today with my partner in innovation, Dr. Kim McKnight. Dr. McKnight is the director for the Center of Teacher Leadership

[01:48:16] and executive director of RTR Teacher Residency at Virginia Commonwealth University. She's a former K-12 public school teacher and coach. She has a PhD in educational psychology and is a national board certified teacher. I'm going to get us started today and then I'll turn it over to Dr. McKnight. As you are aware, so we are in a unique position among all of the lab school applicants in that our proposal includes an already fully formed fully functioning and successful school code rva regional high school the purpose of our proposal is to combine code rva with an

[01:48:52] equally well-known and successful program which is vcu's richmond teacher residency or rtr that's how we refer to it and there are three main ideas in our proposal and i'll go over that first main idea first we prepare we propose to use code rva regional high school as a new placement site for teacher residents here they will learn how to integrate computer science across all subject areas and learn code rva's unique model of personalized learning when they complete this their year of residency they will take their training into hard to staff school divisions across virginia school divisions seeking to replicate code rva in a smaller platform such

[01:49:30] as a school within a school model could group teachers within one school or a feeder pattern additionally our proposal includes providing for a school leader intern annually at code rba the intern will learn how to lead an innovative computer science focused program and then will also enter into a hard to staff school division upon completion of their residency hi um in my thank you so much dr gorenson and thank you all so much for the opportunity um So in addition to the first part that Dr. Goranson explained, the RTR staff will spend time researching best practices, providing professional learning.

[01:50:07] This is really what we've been doing for the past 12 years in the Center for Teacher Leadership. Can you all hear me? Let me get a little closer, better. All right, there we go. I was a kindergarten teacher, so I have that very quiet voice. So I'm going to try to really vocalize here.

[01:50:23] We're excited because we want to really replicate this for a pre-K to eight model. We know that it's great at Code RVA at a high school, but what does that look like to replicate as we go down? And the model builds on 12 years of knowledge and experience in recruiting teacher candidates. We call them residents because it's based on a medical residency model to prepare them through an intensive school-based teacher preparation model.

[01:50:46] Through the last 12 years, we recruit, prepare, and retain high-quality, diverse teacher workforce for high-need schools in the greater Richmond metropolitan area, and have since expanded to 16 school divisions across Virginia. In 2021, RTR launched the school leader residency, which was modeled after our RTR residency for teachers. And just a big reason we did that is the number one reason for exit surveys of people leaving was when they had poor leadership in their schools. So we thought we need to make sure we're really preparing school leaders. To date, RTR has prepared 314 teachers and six school leaders and served 65 schools, trained 239 mentors, and reached

[01:51:25] more than 39,000 students. We had an independent benefit cost analysis that was conducted by the Wilder School of Government and Public Affairs that was able to show our return on investment study when we think about the long-term sustainability. We'll get into that a little later. But one of our proudest statistics is that 99% of our mentor teachers say that being a mentor for RTR made them a more effective teacher. And so for us, we know the teacher shortage is severe.

[01:51:53] And so for us, this is not about recruiting new people, but it's also retaining our veteran teachers. And so lastly, by the end of our five-year lab school grant, we hope to still be the flagship lab school for the Commonwealth of Virginia and to continue to be recognized at the national level for innovation.

[01:52:09] Code RVA students will continue to receive a high-quality computer science education and enter Virginia's workforce upon graduation. They'll have access to VCU's extensive resources, teaching faculty and cutting-edge pedagogy and research. Teachers from across the state will receive high-quality professional learning, and teacher residents will continue to be trained and then sent into classrooms into hard-to-staff divisions.

[01:52:32] Research into the efficacy of our program will have been conducted and continued successes in both the classroom and in teacher preparation will have been documented and shared with school divisions across the Commonwealth, and we want to then share that through the country in implementing school-wide models, and we know we are in the beginning stages of this process, And if our proposal receives approval, we know we will have to engage in a detail-oriented MOU process between CODAR VA's existing school board and VCU's leadership.

[01:53:02] We hope to answer all of your initial clarifying questions today, but if we cannot, we will work to answer them and have them addressed through our MOU process. And we thank you again for the opportunity to address the committee today. Thank you very much. Please have a seat and join us as we begin to prepare to dialogue.

[01:53:21] As a procedural matter, however, though, and as a transparent procedural matter, I just want to, we'll need a motion from the committee to take up your application. The board bylaws, Article 8, Section 2, materials that provide that to be considered by a standing committee, materials must be transmitted at least seven days prior to the meeting in which first review has been scheduled unless waived by unanimous vote of the members.

[01:53:48] vcu and the virginia department of education have been dialoguing about the lab application before us today for the past several months however the video we report on completeness and compliance the paper part of our review along with the application was transmitted to this committee four days prior to the meeting so therefore at this time i'll ask a motion to waive the seven day requirement for advance receipt of the materials to consider the vcu application is there a motion is there a second second got your second today all right i think we should note for discussion that yes it's

[01:54:28] four days we have the materials though in advance and this is first review so just to make sure nobody gets the idea that somehow this is getting through on any less than the exact same scrutiny that all the other applications are going to receive or have received any further discussion on the motion uh i'll offer i know that this is this was something that i i consulted with staff on i know that you have been in deliberations with uh the virginia department of education four months um we were aware of your application that it may be able to come before this committee

[01:55:05] um there were some paperwork really like the writing of the report the the subject matter experts as we understand it already reviewed your material but the actual drafting of the report to come before this committee was not yet finalized in advance of that seven days we had a holiday on monday we didn't have a meeting in may and given those circumstances felt that it was appropriate to make this exception for you so all right so um on the motion all those in favor please signify by saying aye aye any opposed the same the motion is unanimous we can now proceed with the official

[01:55:44] consideration of the vcu application and to consider the documents from the virginia department of education thank you dr rayling yes ma'am thank you miss wadiska so as you noted our subject matter experts have reviewed this application and reviewed it thoroughly and again it was looked at through multiple lenses with a variety of perspectives from a financial standpoint governance standpoint regulatory standpoint instruction accountability a variety of things that we look at through the process we believe that this is a very strong application it is certainly complete and compliant

[01:56:17] And one thing we noted, we felt that they didn't articulate as strongly as they could have really what is happening at Code RVA currently. A lot of great things happening in that space, and I don't think they gave themselves enough credit for what they're doing, quite honestly.

[01:56:34] But I feel that this is a very strong application. The applicant's been really a pleasure to work with and have been very responsive to questions that we have asked of them. And our team is happy to answer any questions that you may have from our standpoint. Thank you, Dr. Really. And thank you again on behalf of the committee for all the work of the subject matter experts in reviewing this application. I know there's so much work that goes on, sometimes, you know, in this case, weeks and months prior before it comes before a body such as this. And I want to thank you for your leadership in bringing this one to us.

[01:57:06] It's been our pleasure. Thank you. All right. At this time, I'm going to open it up for questions. I believe that Dr. Moran has first steps on this one as well. Okay, thank you. And it's great to see both of you. I have such regard and respect for the work that you both are doing and have watched that develop over several years, even before you were at Code RV 800, but it's great to see you today and so appreciated the chance to do a first read through of the proposal that you have in front of us.

[01:57:35] And I think it hits the mark on several cylinders that we're looking for in this engine. And one is that we need spaces where educators are learning how to teach and even lead for the future of young people in schools and not just continue doing what we've always done.

[01:57:57] And so I think that what you're doing is creating a wonderful model that creates a synergy around two proven programs and bringing them together. I think probably says that what you will create will be better than what either of you have right now individually, although both of those are pretty exceptional programs, I think, by any measure.

[01:58:17] So thank you for thinking about this out of the box in terms of the synergy of two programs. I'm not sure that there are many people in the state that would have married those two together. So it's pretty cool that you did. There must be an inside joke on that. So anyway, but I'm going to start in the same place that I did in the first proposal, and that is with sustainability.

[01:58:39] One of the things that I noticed is that you do have a lot of upfront funding that's headed towards building a staffing model. And I'm wondering if you might talk about, in general, what you see as

systems and structures that you believe are going to be essential to sustainability of this particular program, but also how you're planning to address at whatever point you're going to need to say, as we all know, state funding does come to the end for these kinds of programs. How will you see

[01:59:16] a path forward to continue this program, particularly with adding a number of staffing positions? Thank you so much for the question. And again, we feel the same way about you. spells. Thank you. So I'll start with Code RBA is a self-sustaining model with the way that they have tuition-based. And so for the Center for Teacher Leadership, we've been federally funded for the last 15 years. And so we've gotten U.S. Department of Education grants using the What Works Clearinghouse for the new teacher center coaching model. Can you all hear me? I feel like I'm okay. And so we've been able to, we train early childhood, elementary, special education,

[01:59:54] secondary teachers, as well as school leaders. And so each of those, what we've been able to do is take the federal grants, and that's really where staffing has come from. And then what we've done is with a 20% tuition reduction through VCU, we're able to then leverage the teacher residency line item that has a 33% cost share for school division partners.

[02:00:15] On June 23rd, we're actually having a conversation with VCU because at this moment as a grant funded center, we do not receive funds from VCU. But because over the last 12 years they've seen the success, they do get funds from this, what we're trying to do is create a shared cost model from the tuition that comes in so that our staff through the Center for Teacher Leadership can be funded through those as well as VCU having a cost share.

[02:00:41] So the same way that there's a 33% cost share with the school division partners that's written in the legislative language for the teacher residency line item, that's one piece. Another part that I wanted to make sure to bring up is that through the teacher residency apprenticeship program, we did apply for Department of Labor to become an apprenticeship. And so that will come with new funds. And so that's another item as we talk about our expansion is to be able to leverage the Department of Labor.

[02:01:08] So, between the teacher residency line item, the Department of Labor, as well as the cost share with the school divisions, and then creating this cost share with VCU, that federal grant that they were referring to in the last, we've already started it. So, we're always hustling for more funds. And so, as a 100% grant-funded center, this is what we do, and we're pretty good at it. And I say that because our team is extensive.

[02:01:33] And so I did, I had a feeling that staffing would come up in our conversations. But one of the pieces that's been wonderful, A, Kumi and I work really well together. And I've been, I think one of the pieces often that there's this idea that higher ed is the one to bring ideas to K-12.

[02:01:51] but in this, I actually feel very opposite, that we're going to learn far more from what they're doing already at Code RBA. The part that we have resources for, and this is where our team over the last 15 years, everyone on our team, there's about 23 of us, and I say about because one person's like 50%, but all of those positions are former educators, and so these individuals most have doctorates in all of the different areas, elementary, special ed, school leadership,

[02:02:18] And so our goal is by over the last or over the next year, we already have identified two residents that are going to be at Code RVA. So this isn't just I think the difference is this is not just a pie in

the sky idea. This is already ready to go and that we were able to leverage additional funds from other sources to pay for them to get their degrees.

[02:02:40] And so what we already have two mentors at Code RBA. And I think what's important when we talk about professionalizing our profession, teachers need to go through extensive training. And we believe that a residency model is the most important. And so in our service agreement, when you are getting your master's degree, and we're now in the undergraduate spaces too, you're making a three-year commitment to a hard-to-staff school division.

[02:03:05] And so they work that off as a service loan over three additional years, which is why school divisions like our model, because that 33% cost share ends up keeping very high retention numbers on the back end. And so for us, we're going to use the next year with the two residents at Code RVA so we can really learn what it is that they're doing so that we can really change what the future of teacher preparation looks like.

[02:03:30] And so the beauty of this is that our staff are already ready to go to do this expansion because we're in 16 school divisions across Virginia. I think it's one of the best positive parts of COVID is that we switched all of our courses to online modality.

[02:03:46] So now we are in Brunswick and Cerro City, all of which are examples of best practices that are happening at Code RVA, throw in that teacher preparation, and then be able to create more opportunities of innovation and replication across the state. That was a lot. Sorry.

[02:04:05] It's okay. I appreciate the detail. As I said, you can never put enough detail in a grant to satisfy a review committee. So it's always this kind of dialogue that helps. so that that's really um and and you know i always used to challenge people and say so if we don't get this grant we think this is a really great idea what are we going to do and i always loved when somebody would come back and say we're going to make this happen no matter why i bet y'all have said that to each other you got two people that are going to make it yes absolutely absolutely so but the money does help to get something like this off the ground and to really scaffold and build on

[02:04:42] it the other question that i'm really interested in is that when i i opened it up and i saw that the x's by pk all the way up through 12th grade i went wait a second this is code rva what's going to to happen next with this and so i'm really interested in you talking a little bit more in depth about the k-8 piece because that's not as fleshed out in here yes i know code rva i know the quality of what goes on there i'd love to know what you're thinking is more in depth around k-8

[02:05:12] Absolutely. So I can say because we've been training teachers from pre-K all the way up to 12th grade, when people are getting their degrees, we do what's called a gradual release of responsibility. And so they are in the classroom with a mentor teacher from the first day of teacher work week until the last day of school.

[02:05:29] They begin to take on more and more while they're taking their classes at VCU to become a teacher. And so one of the pieces, what we're learning over this first year, and the reason we're keeping it broad, is because we want to make sure that as our two residents that are at Code RBA, our whole staff will be learning alongside them too.

[02:05:47] What is happening? How are we doing this personalized instruction the way Code RBA has already been doing it? But what we're going to then do is put that into our gradual release calendar so that

they can begin to learn all of these different pieces of personalized learning and then start to take it.

[02:06:03] What does it look like to go from ninth grade to eighth grade, from eighth grade to seventh and begin to scale back to all the way down? We were able, using the lab school planning grant, which we appreciate the opportunity to get that too, because we were able to go to, was it Buckingham County? Yes.

[02:06:19] Yeah, I couldn't remember. Yeah, so some of our staff who are doing elementary went and visited, there is a school division that's working on how they take kind of this computer science integration in a public school model for elementary school. So we went and went, I didn't go, but some of the staff went, and then they were able to come back and say, oh, this is totally, we can replicate this.

[02:06:41] And so what we want to figure out is that if we know, begin with the end in mind, which I appreciated you saying, and we agree, we know what it needs to look like in high school. Then with her experience from middle school, as well as, I'm sorry to speak for you, but definitely time in with Bailey Bridge, having done a school within a school model already, we can then take that teacher preparation piece and start to integrate what computer science looks like from the middle school lens to the elementary, all the way down to pre-K.

[02:07:07] The beauty of this is that VCU has already gotten a few grants when it talks about STEM innovation. And so one of them is Yao Ying, who is a professor at VCU, is doing a STEM study for families of preschool students. And so, again, we can begin to take what they're doing there and integrate that into the teacher preparation model. And so, again, I can't give you the very specifics yet. Give us the beginning of this.

[02:07:33] Do you anticipate that you're going to actually have students that you will call PK-8 lab school students or more embedded? I wouldn't call it. Yeah, I think it's more embedded. That's where the professional learning. So for us, one of the things, and I don't know how much our application spoke to it, but Kumi, as well as in a big appreciation to everyone at VDO, we're getting corporate sponsors to think about co-locating for a building. For us, that's a key piece of this, to become an innovation hub that way people from across the state can come to visit but we know

[02:08:09] that not everyone's going to be able to come to region one to do this and so for us when we talk about the students being able to be impacted it's more about the teachers coming learning best practices than implement that within the pre-k8 spaces wherever they are across the state just to kind of yeah absolutely to add to a couple of those threads on that when you're talking about that sustainability piece and then going into looking at the pk8 um the co-location is a key lever for us um in terms of our building we we have a lease we have a great landlord and and certainly love that but you know as a homeowner myself i know it's not fiscally responsible to

[02:08:46] have a lease forever we need a permanent home for our students um and so part of just part of the financial sustainability just in like literally off the bat um we spent a half a million dollars just in rent out of our current tuition base so the minute that we can get into a much more financially stable situation or a physically like stable situation our finances are going to have a major turn you know you're talking for teachers right there that we would be able to hire or supplement our funding with that and and we're moving towards that um during this grant application which is why you see some information about furniture and hardware and access points and

[02:09:22] things to help support students um and then yeah kim alluded to what i did before one of the things i did at bailey bridge when i was the principal there for six years was to start summit learning which was a school within a school model that was an online platform actually very similar to sort of the the thinking behind how code rva works and we did that um and we and it was a scaled up model we started with sixth grade we scaled up the grade level each year and then when i came to code rva just happened to take the two lead teachers for that program with me here total coincidence so they were on board but um really you know it was this idea of students you leveraging

[02:09:58] the very best of online technology having a mentoring component um and learning durable we call them durable skills virginia summit calls them something different but it basically habits of mind um and and using that and so that model is is proven it does have research behind it you know but we would be able to look at how do we create our own blend of that um and kim's team has done a great job kind of researching that K through eight part. I know the middle school part very well. I will say I'm out of my depth, which is why I'm glad we make such a good pair when it looks like K through five. But yeah, definitely looking ahead to kind of plan. If I can just add

[02:10:34] one last thing. I think the beauty of our staff is that we are ready to already begin. We're not having to hire. Everyone's already in existence because we've been training teachers in early childhood, elementary, middle school, and high school for over a decade. And so with that being said, it's going to be, I think, a lot easier for us to take those best practices and then implement them into the teacher preparation spaces, making sure that the students are getting the best impact they can. I think I understood that you have visited some sites. I think I saw 15 as a number

[02:11:09] that either virtually or on, you know, on site, you went to see some schools in operation. What are the takeaways from some of those site visits that you are using to inform this grant that might be different than what you're doing in either program right now? Are there some things that you see as pushing you to innovate up in terms of your thinking? I have one. Well, I was just going to say, we just came back from visiting Crete Academy, which is a charter school out in California. And they serve, I want to say 80% of their students were unhoused or had housing

[02:11:46] instability. And what was really neat about their program is things that we have talked about is the goal of like wraparound services. How does a school become a hub for families who have needs, right? And it may be temporary, it may be ongoing, but how can a school become a location where if families need to have a resource touch point, right? That we are so well known in the community that they know that, oh, if they need to talk to somebody, they can get a number for the right person at this particular agency, you know, whatever it is that they can come to us. Already, we have partnerships with feed more students take advantage of a weekend backpack program to receive meals for weekends and we're exploring ideas for how do we support them

[02:12:22] um for getting like vaccinations or dental care things in a mobile site right like there's a lot of opportunities out there so that was one of my takeaways where i was like how amazing would this be you know as we have an expanded facility and we're able to do outreach it's just another way to connect and support virginia families right we're educating their students but there's so much more as we figured out during covid that goes into students being ready for learning in schools and um california state university dominguez hills which has been both um getting u.s department of education funds the same way that we have for a long time uh far longer than we have uh and one

[02:12:57] of the we were able to visit and they have a huge partnership with toyota and apple and so we were able to see what they do to bring them in for different events. And so it was really nice to get to say, hey, we'd love for you to sponsor this. And so we're now at a place, we're not creating a new idea. We're using what works. But then if you want to speak a little bit about some of the pieces around corporate, because I think that's one of the takeaways. You can't just do this as K-12 higher ed. There has to be private corporate sponsors. But I think the tricky part

[02:13:32] is that I think they're also kind of waiting to see what happens with this type of lab school funding and how this all plays out. So I think there's this piece of like chicken or egg. Which one do we do first? Is it the corporate comes to us and then the lab school? Is it the lab school then the corporate? But we've been having those conversations. So I'd love for you to speak to that.

[02:13:51] Yeah. One of the points we know of inflection that we know we're going to have is when we get into a new facility, the goal of Code RBA is to be 400 students, right? So how do you scale up 50 seats in a year is really challenging for school divisions who typically maybe add one to two seats per year. And so what we're looking at is different ways to how corporations and donations can come into our school, right? So we have already an existing internship program for our students. So all of our students in 11th and 12th grade receive six-week internships all done in-house. And all of those students get it and they all get a great experience. They were going

[02:14:27] a fake company in 11th grade in our school for six weeks. They produce a portfolio at the end of that internship. And then our business partners do mock interviews with our students. So they can kind of have that, you know, fail forward practice of an interview. Then in 12th grade, we do free client work for any business, nonprofit, any community group, anyone who wants to come to us. Our students will do a six week project complete with a scope of work, weekly client meetings and then they have a deliverable at the end that they showcase at a demo day right but looking ahead what does an externship look like and so what we're imagining is that as we

[02:15:04] scale up those seats let's just say capital one one of our partners just for instance let's say that capital one wanted to make a four-year investment and code rva to sponsor 10 seats right capital one makes that initial financial cost investment and then they partner with us to determine how those seats are allocated right do they want to say students from this particular division because this is where the headquarters is physically located, we're all going to get these seats. Do they want to do a proportional allocation, right? Maybe for hard, smaller school divisions that don't have as much financial resources, they could say, okay, so this particular school division will get five seats and Capital One is paid for them, right? And so as part of

[02:15:41] that partnership, looking at externships, what if we were then able, Capital One was to say, we would love to host two Code RVA students for an externship for that six weeks instead of an internship, right? Our students could then go through a rigorous screening process with that employer, and they would get to do a next level, right? So every student still gets the opportunity at internships at both levels, but what if they were able to do placements in the field, right?

[02:16:06] That's what we really see. Each of our grade levels has had about a third of them graduate with associate degrees, so we're turning out students who are employable upon graduation, and I appreciated what Southside was saying in terms of changing that narrative for families, When I grew up, and I grew up

in Augusta County in Virginia, very, very small rural county, it wasn't always, it was like college, you had to go to college if you wanted a certain type of job.

[02:16:30] Well, I think now we're seeing that our students with associate degrees in computer science are immediately able to enter the workforce. We're focusing on durable skills, getting them ready for that idea that our friends were talking about, how do you integrate into a workplace? From the day one at Code RVA, that's what we talk about.

[02:16:47] We don't talk about student discipline, we talk about workplace. um behaviors and we've reframed that conversation for families and so we're looking to continue to do that to say take that you know have your student enter into that say capital one placement right take that associate degree or those technical skills have the employer have a pathway have the student enter the workforce and then look at what sort of additional training they need because i think employers can be really responsive to that and to say like in our corporation we would love to provide a pathway for learning for students um so that's kind of what we're looking i mean like

[02:17:19] ahead for our that next level for our students um for what's beyond graduation thank you mr rotherham we'll go next to you so i'm excited about this i appreciate the conversation on all the things i have a lot of confidence in code rva what you're doing i have a just one question i mean i think i think we're ready to move this forward but i have one question i was looking at the demographics and i was struck um uh that only 10 of the students are hispanic and latino and what i was hoping you could do is talk about sort of is that an underrepresentation and if so

[02:17:59] like what are you thinking about in terms of outreach and communications and what are you thinking about to to boost that level of participation absolutely this continues to be an area of opportunity i think for us um we have made some efforts over to increase that it's gone a little bit if you look at our demographics it has gone slightly up each year um we continue to look to try to look for creative ways to recruit in in specifically like neighborhoods and communities um one of our ptsa president actually um has suggested she her family her their first language is spanish um and she suggested that we start doing more neighborhood

[02:18:36] presentations and less at the schools for this particular community so we recruit heavily in schools we recruit um you know we have our own events that we host regularly um but we've had some ideas to look at how do we get into the community maybe either if it's not in a neighborhood a community center a church and we're perfectly comfortable going to those venues to recruit i usually do it myself and take students with me or take other staff members but we are always looking to get those numbers up to encourage more students to apply we know that um there's just there's an opportunity out there we know that we could do better with that for sure so certainly making that an area of focus moving forward in general but with this population with our our new application

[02:19:15] too. I can add to that too. So we have a full-time recruiter on our team. That was one of the pieces that we knew and that's normally for teachers. But I think again as we leverage resources, again this is something and then one of the leaders of LULOC is a professor at VCU. So again now that we know this is an area that needs to be improved this is where we leverage resources and feel like we could hit that easily as far as trying to increase that number. So again this is something that I really feel like each time we hear that this is a challenge it's like oh let's just share that and then we're able to help one another and i know it's not in your grant but it does strike

[02:19:51] me with you saying that that many places are starting to say how do we look down to high school to find kids that want to be teachers yes and hard to teach areas like computer science and math so maybe a two birds with one stone kind of focus and so we started teachers for tomorrow in Southampton as a way to pilot what does it look like for us at higher ed to be involved in teachers for tomorrow instead of just high school you know doing that on their own which again it can be successful but this is to me a perfect opportunity to then marry exactly what you're saying and then

[02:20:28] involve the best practices of what's happening because we keep talking about the future of learning we're forgetting the future of teaching and that's the piece of this that we can't change what's happening for students if we don't change how we're preparing teachers we'll go back to mr rotherham do you have any more questions sir you're on mute and i think you're on mute sorry it's my first time on a video meeting uh no no other questions this is really exciting and i think again like one of the things when you when you think is just like the diversity of ideas that

[02:21:03] we're getting in different areas of emphasis uh yeah i won't i won't go into my enthusiasm for the one at wallops island you guys have heard that as nauseam but just the different kinds of things we're getting and so seeing code uh rva here and and with this emphasis is fantastic so thank you thank you thank you mr rothrao mr bailey no i just want a second it's exciting um and actually some of my questions were just answered through andy and dr morin and it's also i'd love to learn a little bit more about where you are in the registered apprenticeship process you mentioned do which i know is complicated it could take some time so just love to to learn a little bit more

[02:21:41] about where you are in that i'm happy to so um it's a complicated answer but i'm going to give you a high level um there's been some changes um on at this kind of the point people yes um and so at this point what we did is we were able to register but then we were put on pause because

[02:22:02] Virginia Department of Education also has an application that they are putting forward for the state, so we went through that process, too, because there was an apprenticeship planning grant, and we applied with Fairfax, Prince William, and Surrey, and so the beauty of what we did is that we were actually working with Shannon, who's from Department of Labor, doing apprenticeships.

[02:22:23] What was nice is that we are able to roll out what we do already because it is a year-long residency and it's been unpaid. So what we're able to do is then create a new FTE position within school divisions called a teacher resident apprentice. And so then we are able to leverage those labor funds.

[02:22:42] But this individual, instead of them being unpaid, they are now going to be an employee and they're spending the year in a mentor teacher's classroom. So we were able to take everything we already do, copy and paste it into the application. And then a lot of it's more about language. So like when they call it related technical instruction, we call it, so it's taking this crosswalk between the definitions of what higher ed uses for teacher prep, and then what department of labor for journey workers and all of those pieces.

[02:23:08] And so we did a crosswalk already. We already have it all there. And then we did apply for one of the implementation grants for apprenticeship with both Prince William and for Surrey. And so what's exciting is that those things have already been laid out. We have residents that are going to be starting in the fall. And the school divisions have committed to having them become paid employees in the school.

[02:23:29] So we're really excited because again, we know you can't just live on ramen to become a teacher. And unfortunately, we've all relied on that. And so now we know they need to get paid. And the saying that you earn while you learn, that is really what we're trying to do to leverage those funds.

[02:23:46] Great. That's very helpful. Then second, there was a section of the application where you talked about you differ from traditional high schools and that the marking periods are not averaged together. Instead, there's earning points. And I was trying to understand if that's like more competency-based or could you just talk a little bit more about the points process?

[02:24:07] Sure. So we do use cumulative grading. So rather than students averaging marking periods over nine weeks, what we do are six-week segments, right? So we look at the school improvement cycle, six to eight weeks is really an ideal timeframe for looking at student interventions.

[02:24:22] So we want students to have six-week cycles where they can show their learning, we can implement interventions to support them as needed, and then we can move forward and change if needed to support the student additionally. But essentially, students just, it's regular grading.

[02:24:38] I mean, like you would know, except we call things mastery grading. So you don't get an A on your report card, you would get an exceeding mastery, right? You would get a partial mastery if you're getting a C, full mastery for a B, and so on down. And so the students are kind of getting that feedback throughout the year. And then at the end of the marking period, that six weeks, the assignments do close, right? Because we do know that sometimes high school kids can be procrastinators. So mine, number one. So the marking periods do close, but then the grade continues to pick up, right?

[02:25:11] So student A at the last day of the first marking period, say, has an 89, they come into school the next day, they have another assignment, their grades then added into that 89. So they can't go back and access those assignments that were from the first marking period, but their grades continue.

[02:25:27] And so we really try to focus students on the target of the overall grade. So the parents do get what we call snapshots, traditional report cards every six weeks, but we use Canvas. they can look at their grades at any time in real time and we say by the time you get your six-week snapshot your kid has already earned a bunch more grades but essentially it gets students to look towards the final goal right the goal is mastery and it gives our students our teachers more opportunity to be flexible right if they're getting towards the end of the year and the student has demonstrated that partial mastery and the teacher can then look right at that last marking period and say look i've watched i've watched you grow there's still some things that you need to

[02:26:05] work on right some some areas that you're still a little bit behind it let's get those in and that's helping your grade and so our students they they add up those grades all year at the end of the year they receive a final grade just like anyone else and then we do offer summer school um summer session we're extended school year right now so our students can receive additional remediation or acceleration if they're on the dual enrollment track so those students who maybe still didn't make the number progress that they need to do they come in to the summer um and depending on what subject area it is they spend additional days with us in the summer again still hitting those

[02:26:40] areas with the idea that they're moving on and they they're getting those skills and we talk about in a small school environment right all of our students come in at different levels of readiness but once they get to us we are now responsible for every area of readiness for them and so we have a lot of

control being in a small school then so we really that individualized learning is key for us i want to know because what you need is different from what you need even if you're in the same class and so how do we tailor that learning for students and so that's our brand of personalized learning that we use very exciting thank you well let me first say

[02:27:18] that i'm incredibly impressed with the quality of your application it is readily apparent um you tick tick tick through many of the things that i'm looking for you have support from your local school division and school board you have support you have clear articulated vision of how you will handle governance you have a detailed financial model that leverages federal funds and hopefully even more to come which is astute on your part you have a very succinct and thorough examination of how you will uh provide services to students with disabilities incredibly thorough answer we

[02:27:56] already do it yes i appreciate that tremendously and um and you've provided some information on family engagement i think we might want to see a bit more if we could give you a homework assignment in your next iteration if you would and you've provided a bit of it to us verbally but again for the record i think we would like to see build out how you plan to further engage families and the opportunity i mean that really is a hallmark of if if lab schools are approved created in communities but but families aren't familiar with the option available we still haven't we've missed

[02:28:35] the mark so i really want you to kind of sharpen your pencil on that item um but otherwise this was just spit spot very impressive and uh you know i think what's really just a happy coincidence today in a way is that we've seen there's really kind of three purposes of lab schools the first is to help improve you know teaching out to study how students learn and the third is to provide opportunities for young people and we have the benefit of seeing all three of those today specifically i'm so enthusiastic about your work for the teacher residency uh you know the

[02:29:12] individuals going into that profession are already making a commitment to the public good and we want to make it more affordable for diverse populations of all socioeconomic backgrounds to enter the teaching profession that is so core but when financial hurdles are erected such as a teacher residency and you have to forego an income it it limits who may be able to come into the classroom as a teacher to begin with so i i really appreciate that you're dialing in on the issue of teaching

[02:29:46] as that is without question a matter that we need more thoughts on i'll say to you that there's two things that we said to the other applicant these aren't homework assignments these are more invitations the first is going to be when we conclude this process with you we're going to be looking for your feedback is there anything that we can do to improve our work here either be at the committee or be on a staff level you know just as i said to the other applicant it's a two-way street we really believe in a shared model of responsibility and we're going to want to know from you what more do you need and what more can we do to be a partner in the work and the second is these points of friction you're going to hear this you know but you're going to probably be

[02:30:25] bumping into things with the teacher residency program in particular that you're going to gain an insight on and you will help us by giving us that feedback and elevating it so that we can also in turn share that information to the state board of education so just keep those two items in your mind you know i always say if there's a moment of um angst about something i that angst we hope can mean growth and improvement and we do invite the feedback so with that um is there a motion to accept this application for first review and clear the application for our 10-day public comment period

[02:31:10] all those in favor of the motion seconded by mr rothangham please signify by saying aye aye any opposed the same all right the ayes have it the motion is approved on behalf of the committee i therefore direct the staff to post the vcu lab school application for a 10-day public comment period in accordance with the standing committee's procedures then to compile any comments received for review by the standing committee when the application returns for second review in july we'll make sure that the date is known to you and and available and we thank you and congratulations

[02:31:46] on moving forward through the process thank you so much all right at this point in the agenda we are going to take up item c which is first review of revisions to the college partnership Laboratory School Application. Mr. Chapman? Welcome. Thank you very much. Ms. Wadiska, members of the committee, we are very excited to have for you another iteration of the College Partnership Laboratory School Application. As a little bit of a background on this item,

[02:32:23] substantive reviews on this application really began back in March when, you know, the staff was meeting with Ms. Wadiska to kind of, you know, go through this and try to make sure this process was was as clean as possible and certainly you know looking at everything from some of the technological limitations of the current application which is still in a word format from back in 2008 and maybe not up to snuff in terms of giving our applicants the best opportunity to utilize things like collaborative sharing that's possible on on SharePoint and with other aspects of the Microsoft platform but also really going through the application in finer detail

[02:33:02] trying to make sure that as this process got stood up that you all were put in a position to receive from the application the types of information that you were looking for the primary hurdle in this process as a note has really been the lack of volume you know but that's a problem that you all are taking care of here today at this meeting and we are so excited to see these first few applications you know moving before you all and and just as a as a little bit of that you know know, because this is, you know, a very big ship, you know, it's moving now and it's steering, we are

[02:33:35] certainly learning a lot from the applications that the subject matter expert group has had a chance to revise, and certainly even are taking very diligent notes on the work that and the types of questions that you all are asking here, just to be sure that as revisions continue, that we're being attentive to finding the information that you all are looking for, and making sure that the application reflects the process that you all are building and how it is that you would like to get this information to the fore. As staff learns more about that, again, we'll be glad to continue making those revisions. I'd also like just to mention that we really do owe a lot of gratitude

[02:34:15] in addition to Ms. Wadiska and certainly Ms. Vineski, who's shouldered the burden of a lot of these revisions. Our applicants are really an unnamed partner in this, as they've been very patient with a really very old and outdated application and have really been working very collaboratively with the department with Dr. Raley to make sure that we are getting the information through the revision process. Dr. Raley is really good about noting that the coaching process of the application and the disposition of the department is towards coaching. We certainly don't want to be coaching just because we haven't asked for the right information. So as we go

[02:34:53] through these revisions, that's certainly a goal is to minimize the burden upon our applicants primarily, but also to make the staff process more efficient and certainly to make sure that the applications you are receiving reflect the quality and the kinds of information that you're looking for. From a high level,

the types of overviews that I think you'll see in this first round of revisions that the subject matter expert group has now had an opportunity to revise and to look at in addition to myself and to Ms. Vinesky.

[02:35:23] We do have a significant amount of updated facility information in page three. In the process of going through some of the applications, we noticed that the application didn't really distinguish very well between the types of physical space that was being utilized. Certainly, if a lab school proposal is looking to accommodate 500 students, but they have a single room, that's information that you all would like to know and it sort of helps paint the picture of what's happening there. And certainly with the school within a school model that we expect to become very popular and that we're so excited to see, making sure that you all understand from the physical side where students are being housed, how much space is being dedicated within school

[02:36:03] systems, within the school divisions, within particular schools to the lab school, we thought would be an important part of your revision process. We've made more clear requests for memorandums of understanding and other agreements upon which applications rely so that you can all see that along with the application we thought uh you know even today we've heard a lot of that type of questioning making sure that that information is prominent um and disclosed up front one thing that we are very interested to see how this filters through and would love to get your feedback

[02:36:38] on we do have a suggestion on page eight to refocus the executive summary um the executive summary i think we found tended to be kind of a catch-all in the current applications and really an opportunity to give a very broad and detailed and and i think um unnecessarily exhausted at that point in the application you know plan for how the lab school was supposed to function however we think that that might have been detracting from some of the answers because it then felt repetitive through the application and so the the refocused executive summary is really focusing

[02:37:13] upon a, you know, a high-level summary, sort of the 500 words that might go into the press release, you know, so that then through the application, it's not feeling as repetitive. There we have the large focus. Here it is. It's short. It's concise. And then we can move into the application and get the details really in the questions where you're all looking for it. We've also added a couple questions or at least one question on page eight to make sure that we're highlighting the types of innovation that we hear you all asking for, making sure that that aspect of the plan is really drawn out a little bit more. There are requests for more detailed integrations with courses of study,

[02:37:51] especially as a lot of these applications are rightfully and we think as a real strength partnering with local school divisions, making sure that you all have that information for how it is that the lab school plans to integrate with the local courses of study, and especially the types of prerequisites that the lab school might have in mind for students entering into their program. You know, that obviously is a big thing. We want to make sure that a student who's applying for a lab school, that parents and teachers both alike, when you have a 6th, 7th, 8th grader, that they can start tailoring their education and making sure that they're on the

[02:38:30] correct course as well to move into the lab school program. We do have revised questions about assessments and performance measures to make sure, again, those are clear how that information is being developed, how the performance assessments are being developed, how they align with state standards. We've asked for additional clarification specifically about governance structures and roles,

functional reporting, that being on page 13. And certainly a key question that was added as well, focused on the decision-making processes for new policies, these being public schools and

[02:39:06] public bodies, making sure that you all have a clear picture of when a school goes ahead and develops policies, how will they be able to engage stakeholders, specifically parents, and making sure that these policies are being developed, you know, in collaboration with the community in which they're, they're serving. Significantly, and I think this is the big, one of the big aspects that has changed since you all saw the preview at the April meeting, is there's been a lot of work done on the financial section and the financial disclosures, just to make sure that, again, that information is a little bit more prominently displayed, that it's more comprehensive in what's

[02:39:43] being asked for, and I think that it itemizes for applicants the types of information that subject matter experts are looking for in-house, but also we think that would be beneficial for the standing committee. Again, that's one of the major revisions since April. These revisions are being presented to you on first review today. As I mentioned earlier, staff has taken diligent notes about the types of questions that you all are asking, and we are excited to go back as we continue to get a few more applications as we receive the revisions from the applicants you heard from and approved today to get public comment. And we'll be glad to integrate those

[02:40:22] into another round of revisions to bring back to you at your next meeting. We will be sure to clearly note for you any additional changes that have been made between this review and final review. Mr. Chapman, Ms. Vineski, I want to wholeheartedly thank you for the painstaking attention that is required to improve the quality of the application. I cannot underscore enough that we cannot have high-quality applications without a high-quality application for the lab

[02:40:56] schools to utilize. And so you, this has been an important, incredibly important responsibility and you have shouldered that burden well and effectively. And, you know, we've talked a bit on the committee about the importance of really modeling a growth mindset and modeling a mindset of innovation that we're going to learn things as we move through this process. And when it's important, we apply that to our work. And this is a case example, number one of that, that as we received initial applications occurred to the committee and to staff that further refinements

[02:41:30] were necessary to the application to really elicit the type of information that was necessary and to also help prompt applicants to ensure that their application would be not only complete but also compliant and so this is a significant improvement but i do know from talking with staff that a tremendous amount of work has been put into this so i want to thank you for your revisions the standing committee will accept them for first review and i would ask the subject matter expert team to continue to look at the application as i know you will especially after we have further ones and i do anticipate that we'll see you again a couple more times on this in fact i

[02:42:05] hope we will because that's part of what we're modeling here right is as we're learning we're we're refining as we're learning we're refining so you'll always have a standing place on the committee agenda promise that as you see things that need to be refined please come back to us but for now thank you and we accept this as first review we're looking forward to it thank you very much all right at this time i want to check uh real quickly with staff i believe that mr hansen

[02:42:32] is trying to get back into the meeting and have we been able to let him in i'm just going to hold

[02:42:46] until we're able to include mr hansen yeah okay we're going to take a five minute recess just to

[02:43:18] handle some of our technical matters and then we'll come back thank you oh that is a much clearer

[02:43:26] version yeah she'll she'll come back okay all right we are back thank you for that at this time

[02:47:34] we're going to proceed with item D, which is an update from Dr. Raley. He's going to provide an update to us on learning pathways in Virginia, a historical perspective. This will give us a wonderful sense of lab schools and the history of them here in the Commonwealth of Virginia. Dr.

[02:47:51] Raley, thank you. Yes, ma'am. Thank you for the opportunity to share. This is graduation season. When I think about a high school graduation, I think about the multiple pathways a student has taken to get that diploma and walk across the stage and complete their high school experience.

[02:48:07] And for some students, it was an easy 13 years. They could have graduated maybe in less time than 13 years. But for other students, it was a real struggle. But ultimately, they took different paths to get to that one endpoint. And so I use that analogy because here in Virginia, there are multiple pathways for students to get a really high quality education. And so we are on the lab school agenda. But ultimately, I want to share a few things that are not lab school options just to highlight some of the different alternatives that are available for students in the commonwealth and then again highlight how we can personalize some of these experiences for

[02:48:44] students so my goal for today is to talk a little bit about the definition of lab schools in virginia we hit some of that so i'm going to not get deeply into that conversation because we spent some really good work on that today talk about some of those additional personalized pathways share a little bit about where we are today. Dr. Alvin's going to come behind me, so I'm not going to go into great detail about that, and then have an opportunity to engage in some conversation at the end. So as Ms. Wadiska mentioned earlier today, lab schools have been in existence in the United States for quite some time. Probably the most famous of the lab school concepts is the

[02:49:18] Dooley Lab School at the University of Chicago, and lab is short for laboratory, and so ultimately they were designed at one point in time to say, "Hey, let's try something new and different. Let's see how it goes let's try this and ultimately measure whether or not we are achieving success and oftentimes that's a collaboration between a college or university and a local school division and many of those have been developed to develop a future teacher workforce so here in the commonwealth we have code that references what lab schools are for us and several different code

[02:49:51] citations and you can see that listed on the screen but ultimately code section 22.1-349-1 B, states that lab schools are designed to stimulate innovation, provide opportunities for innovation and instruction and assessment, provide teachers with an avenue for delivering innovative instruction, encourage performance-based educational programs, high standards for both teachers and administrators, collaboration between pre-kindergarten teachers and post-secondary providers, and develop model programs.

[02:50:22] So you see innovation clearly explicitly written in that legislation. So here in Virginia, what is a lab school? A lab school is an independent, innovative public school built on partnership and evidence that is open to all students through a randomized selection process, through a lottery.

[02:50:38] And as I referenced earlier today, lab schools can come to life one of two ways. That's as a standalone entity responsible for obtaining its own accreditation with support, without support from an existing school and a school division. A lab school can also come to life as a program and act as an extension of a local public school already in existence, similar to a governor's school.

[02:51:00] Those schools that are identified as a program lab school use a collaborating local school division framework to meet the standards of quality. So two different ways that we can achieve that ultimate goal. Lab schools are opportunities available to all students with no barriers, performance-based programs that deliver outcomes, serve as model programs across the Commonwealth as referenced in the legislation and ultimately administered and managed by a governing board.

[02:51:27] And this committee has referenced some of that work today in your previous deliberations. So in addition to lab school, what are some other personalized learning pathway options that are available to students in the Commonwealth? And I want to highlight just a few of them for us while we're together today.

[02:51:43] Charter schools are referenced in the Code of Virginia, and they are alternative public school options located in a local school division under the authority of a local school board. Governor schools were started in 1973 with the foundation being the first summer residential program.

[02:52:02] They provide some of the state's most able students academically and artistically challenging programs beyond those offered in their home schools. are a couple examples of those. Some are residential governor schools, some are regional governor schools, and academic year programs. We have 18 different academic governor schools here in the commonwealth and you can see that they're geographically located across the commonwealth in a variety of communities here in Virginia. Some residential governor schools are targeting the needs of high school juniors and seniors and as implicit in the name they live on a college or

[02:52:40] university campus and they receive intentional intensive educational experiences in specialty areas like visual and performing arts mathematics science technology or opportunities through mentorship programs and regional governor schools are similar but they focus mostly on elementary and middle school students in a variety of different formats some are housed at a public school or some are housed at a college or university usually a period of time lasting one to four weeks, there are two schools that are in fact residential. And you heard from the applicant who I have defined as an innovative high school in this presentation, established in the

[02:53:19] fall of 2016, and certainly their secret sauce is computer science. They're currently serving over 350 students but want to serve more. As we know, they provide multiple pathways for students to earn an associate's degree and work-based credentials. That experience for students Code RVA is highly personalized, and they use a lottery system. So many of the things that are inherent in lab schools, as you referenced in your deliberations today, are alive and well at Code RVA. Other innovative models are what are defined as network school programs. And so these programs in these schools use curriculum, professional development, and support of an

[02:53:56] established network to sustain their programs, providing public school options for students in those communities. They're often operated as a special program within a school division. And so the first of those being an international baccalaureate school. And so these are defined programs by the International Association of Schools who share curriculum for elementary, middle, and high school.

Schools here in Virginia can apply. 43 high school programs now. 41 middle school programs currently in the Commonwealth. But across the globe, there are 5,600 IB schools

[02:54:32] in 159 countries. New Tech Network is another opportunity for students to receive some personalized opportunities. New Tech Network schools prioritize student engagement through the investigation of real-world problems. Probably the one most notable is in San Diego, but they invest in high levels of professional development. There are four New Tech schools in Virginia. As referenced a little bit in two of our applicants today, there are opportunities for students in the commonwealth to receive college credit before they uh you know actually

[02:55:08] enroll into a two or four-year institution many of our local school divisions have partnerships where students can earn an associate's degree before they graduate from high school so i want to highlight some of those programs for us today an example is the advanced college academy which is here in richmond it's a partnership with local school divisions and here in region one with j sergeant reynolds community college and those partnerships exist across the commonwealth students don't have to necessarily earn an associate's degree they can certainly get college credit that can be applicable to their next step in their academic career so a great

[02:55:43] opportunity to reduce cost for families give students a leg up and an advantage as they are transitioning into their two or four year experience lab schools so lab schools in virginia have been around for quite some time believe it or not hampton university operated a lab school between 1870 and 1996. virginia state university ran a lab school in the late 1800s in the early 1900s targeted different grade levels before it ended but it also but it ended ultimately as a

[02:56:18] high school old dominion and virginia commonwealth university may not necessarily be defined as a lab school per se but they are an institute of higher education that supports academic programming for students in certain grade levels vcu here locally in richmond operates a child development center as a preschool program so again there are examples of where collaboration between local school divisions and institutes of higher education have been taking place in the commonwealth for many many years so most recently the conversation regarding lab schools started with governor

[02:56:54] mcdonald's administration in 2010 and funding was provided there with startup grants for universities however that funding did not reveal itself in any sort of sustainable program and any opportunity for for lab schools to come to life but thankfully we are here in 2023 and we have the opportunity now to make this happen and i'm real excited to be a part of the work and thankful for your service and what we can do to make this really a reality in the commonwealth so looking forward to being a part of the work. As we know, the 2022 special session of the General Assembly

[02:57:30] approved $100 million total and separated those funds into different funding buckets, $5 million for planning grants, $20 million for initial startup, and $75 million for per pupil operating grants. And so you are now considering two of those applicants for access to those $75 million for operating grants moving forward. So there's a lot of things that are happening behind the scenes with lab schools here in Virginia, you're considering two, as we know, and we have 16 planning grants that are in the cube. We most recently awarded a planning grant to Roanoke

[02:58:06] College, and Dr. Alvin's going to hit a little bit about that later on in our agenda today, but you see that there's a footprint across the Commonwealth, and so we are ultimately hoping to have greater saturation across the Commonwealth and more and more opportunities for students in their

neighborhood and their communities and our school videoe is here to provide technical technical assistance and support to those school the school divisions and institutes have hired that will be a part of the work so as i said 16 grants awarded two under consideration and of course you're considering two full applications at this point in time so ultimately there is a history of innovation in the commonwealth through a variety of different

[02:58:45] mechanisms whether it's lab schools or network schools or dual enrollment that's alive and well in the commonwealth and so now we have the opportunity to take that work to the next level through our work together with lab schools and uh again excited to be a part of the work so happy to answer any questions that you may have dr really thank you for that excellent report questions or comments from the committee members i just appreciate you expanding beyond just the lab school proper as we're working here to really take a look at innovation and it would be interesting to bring them all together on one map and say okay where all those governor schools were and really

[02:59:25] look at it because i think it would light up virginia see those yes ma'am i really appreciate the presentation i you know the committee has talked a bit about the importance of really building and helping to build an ecosystem to sustain innovation we know that virginians have been very innovative in the k-12 space we know that they have really had a lot of success we know that there's a lot of options and pathways for young folks and it's a good reminder and refresher to catalog what the options are today and and i do believe that behind the scenes i

[03:00:01] think that staff may be working on dr moran's a wish list of putting this up on a map and i'm hoping that in a future meeting we might be able to see that but i really want to say thank you for putting this together i think it's it's important to always reflect on where we've been and how we're continuing to build on those successes and innovation and uh we're looking forward to this opportunity and collaborating with you yes ma'am thank you all right at this time um we actually um while you're here dr really would you like to also provide us with the update on

[03:00:37] the innovation incubator on the may 3rd event okay yes ma'am really quickly and again this is a collaboration from multiple agencies within state government the virginia department of education collaborated with the governor's office and on may 3rd we held an innovation incubator setting an opportunity and miss wadiska was a part of that work she provided some great insight into the standing committee's process and i think it was very valuable we had 130 individuals in attendance at that event we had representatives not only from vdoe but largely from k-12 education as well as institutes from higher education we also had a tremendous amount of business

[03:01:16] and industry leaders who were there so it was a tremendous opportunity to network get to know one another ask questions the folks who have a planning grant that's been approved they had a chance to talk about their planning grant and so from that it spurred some ideas was able to be able to make some connections that were not previously there so it was really really positive and so our agency has committed to technical assistance for all of those applicants and so one of the things that we're going to do this week is reach back out to those individuals who attended the innovation incubator and say thank you for attending we want to support you along the way here's where we are

[03:01:53] here's a status update on what's happening with applications and planning grants and oh by the way we want to support you through the use of office hours or opportunities for us to continually engage with you because we want to see this work we want to support this work and ultimately see it to grow so

that we have multiple applications coming to you for your consideration so it was symbolic of collaboration multiple agencies working together to support this great work and really a positive development in the lab school work in virginia thank you dr railey any questions for members of the committee or comments on that report yeah sure i really want to compliment the

[03:02:30] virginia department of education we've talked again on the committee about the importance of building a community of practice really building out this ecosystem that'll be durable sustainable uh a shared model of responsibility believing that you know we're all in this together and this was a physical representation of that where schools were literally training each other talking to each other sharing with each other hey i'm thinking about this hey what you're doing over there that's kind of similar over here hey let's talk with one another that's incredibly powerful that that's kind of so the first element is that opportunity to network with fellow virginians

[03:03:09] is so important so thank you for affording the planning grant awardees and the business community the opportunity to come together and then secondly thank you for your commitment and please extend this to dr coons for having ongoing engagement ongoing professional opportunities to really help refine and cultivate this community i think that's going to be so incredibly important so thank you yes ma'am welcome all right this we keep the best for last i know i mean almost because we know that everyone wants to hear what's going on with the planning grants and the pipeline so now we've

[03:03:47] moved to item f which is the update on approved college partnership laboratory school planning grants we always enjoy hearing from dr album and he always has some very exciting planning grant awardee that he tells us about and we get very excited and then he reminds us that we have to wait um and that they're learning and growing and we'll have to learn and grow with them so dr album please we look forward to hearing from you and your report today thank you very much chair with this again it's still my mission that before we're all done with this we'll be calling it laboratory schools but so in the genesis of uh laboratory schools in virginia there are two

[03:04:27] on-ramps to be able to become a laboratory school the one is to jump right in both feet and to do a full lab school application much like our first applicant this morning southern virginia the second way is to first embark on a one-year process of applying for a planning grant which affords you the opportunity to access some funds and 12 months to work through the process of putting together all of your planning to put forward to the board a really good solid lab school application much like our second applicant this morning which was the code rva in senior

[03:05:02] partnership. So as Dr. Rayleigh pointed out previously, we do have 16 labs, planning grant applications that are working through at this time. One came forward to you today being the code RVAVCU. 14 of the planning grant applicants are working through their process and the boards work with them is to provide them ongoing technical feedback. And that also includes a disbursement of funding over four quarters. The applicants submit an update report to us.

[03:05:39] Most of that is operational. Here are the things that were on our timeline, and it's measuring a comparison, what they have done with that, as well as an invoice, and we disperse them with a portion of their planning grant. Today, I will share with you that since the last time I had the opportunity to speak with you about lab school applications. We have received two new planning grant applications. One we are still working with on some technical assistance before we are able to bring it to you, but the other one I'm excited to share with you that Roanoke College

[03:06:14] has been awarded a planning grant. They are doing this in partnership with Salem City Schools as well as Virginia Western Community College. Their plan is to have a laboratory school which will be a high school program for 9th graders through 12th graders. The first year they will have a cohort of 25 students who will go through their program. Their goal really is to do what many of the lab schools are doing a spectacular job of is targeting a group of students who are

[03:06:50] not self-identifying as being college bound or career bound. They're pretty much home bound. These are students who have not shown an impetus to go forward with what am I going to do? So what Roanoke College is working with Salem City Schools, as well as Virginia Western, in order to reach a group of students who certainly do have the capacity and capability to be successful post secondary. However, they are not jumping in it yet. So they're working with Salem City Schools to put out the opportunity for students to apply. They are going to target at-risk students,

[03:07:29] but with that, they are looking to be able to leverage those students who do have potential and capacity to be able to do some dual enrollment work. Students who will be part of the Roanoke College Laboratory Schools will be able to work in dual enrollment opportunities that fall within four areas. One, general education. Two, STEM fields. Three, communication and civic leadership, as well as the fourth one being education and global studies. The greater role of the Roanoke College Laboratory School application is to provide

[03:08:05] opportunities for students who have had difficulties access traditional college preparatory programs, and that is what they're building their entire application around. Thank you. Thank you, Dr. Elvam. We always look forward to your reports.

[03:08:21] Pleasure. All right. At this time for discussion of current issues, I have one item to bring before the committee. The May Lab Committee meeting was canceled to afford a transition for Dr. Coons and Dr. Raley's arrival, as well as additional time to thoroughly review the lab school applications that we considered today with subject matter experts. After consulting with staff and in consideration of the State Board of Education schedule. Therefore, this committee will be adding an additional meeting on July 7th to afford a second review of the two applications considered for first review today. The committee will also meet as planned on July 31st to hear

[03:09:00] from international and national experts in lab schools. So at this time, I would entertain a motion that the lab committee add a meeting date for July 7th. So moved. Is there a second? Second.

[03:09:16] All those in favor of the motion please signify by saying aye aye those opposed the same all right the motion unanimous the carries please note for the public record that will be adding a meeting on July 7 and please notify the two applicants that will take them up for a second review at that date.

[03:09:34] are there any further um at this point are there any other current items for discussion from committee members otherwise I'm going to go to public comment on non-agenda items since we have a Ms. Thompson here who has been patiently waiting Thomas excuse me Ms. Thomas has been patiently waiting for us no okay Ms. Thomas we welcome your your feedback well um please come up to the microphone so that we could come up to the one at the podium. Please state your name and if you feel comfortable what city you're from and what organization you might be with. And then you have

[03:10:12] three minutes to provide input. Thank you. First, my name is Mary Ann Thomas. Most people know me by Anne Thomas. I'm from Emporia, Virginia, and right at the border down there. And I

[03:10:36] want to start a charter school for birth to five. I know that the Board of Education is now has taken birth to five under, well, birth to three. So I was wondering if there is or would be

[03:11:10] charter schools for birth to three. And that's the question that I have. I want to thank you for allowing me to come, first of all. But that's my question. Ms. Thomas, we appreciate you driving all the way from emporia virginia having been out that way you probably you get the award today for the longest drive without question and i appreciate your husband drove oh well you're going to enjoy that drive home then all that good company but thank you for being here what i'm going to have

[03:11:46] staff do is i'm going to direct mr chapman to follow up with you directly this committee is considering lab schools we don't do charter schools however mr chapman can follow up with you and provide you with information on charter schools and what the statutes and the requirements are here in the commonwealth of virginia sounds like we may i could i could fill out an application for a lab school but let's let's have staff chat with you after this meeting and we can find a time maybe for him to get on the phone with you ma'am and then we'll follow up and you know i want to make sure that you'll get all your questions answered and we can follow up and we'll certainly

[03:12:23] let the state board of education know that you were here today as well we'll put that in our staff report that goes to them at the next meet for the next meeting okay your time was well spent so thank you for being here thank you thank you very much all right if there are any further business from committee members or comments i just want to say that it was thrilling the day to both hear from the staff bringing these applications forward but also the opportunity to really realize that even with the constraints that sit inside both law and policy, that there

[03:12:59] are people that are thinking about how do we work inside the banks of the river, but go after innovative thinking about what's possible and not let those constraints create what some people seem to think of as impossibilities. It was great to see a couple of examples of people who see possibilities. So I loved it today. It was a good conversation. And just love the engagement with

[03:13:32] the applicants that came in today. I would like to, since we have Mr. Rotherham on the phone, so I would say, Mr. Rotherham, and I know you will, please convey to the State Board of Education our gratitude for being able to serve on the standing committee and to be of service to the state board in this capacity. I know it's meaningful to me. I know it's meaningful to the other board members, but I really appreciate the patience that the state board of education has afforded us to build a high quality process here that is deliberative, that has multiple

[03:14:09] points of engagement from the public, that utilizes the subject matter expertise from the Virginia Department of Education staff. You could have certainly asked for something immediate, it, but the State Board of Education has prioritized quality over, in this case, quickness, and I think as a result, we're going to, we saw today two high-quality applications, and I'm very grateful for the support that we have also received from the State Board of Education to create that process and to run that process, and that's what we saw today, so thank you.

[03:14:42] Well, thank you, and I can, I think I can speak on behalf of the entire board. Everyone's extremely grateful for your service, Pam and John, your leadership on this, Joan, and I want to echo something you said earlier i don't think i'm giving away any state secrets by pointing out it's been a really busy time for the uh department the last couple of months with the transition and the work that uh the staff there has done to keep the trains moving the revise um uh the application as we just went through

and so forth is really is really commendable because people have a lot on their on their plate so it's been a great team effort thank you hearing no further business we stand adjourned



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